UPSTATE / NEW YORK WITHOUT THE CITY

Finger Lakes

The glaciers finished. Then the interesting part began.

Regional Guide — Working Document

Rural Tourism Network / Upstate | March 2026 | v1

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PART 1

Regional Landing Page

Tourismo CMS fields + extended guide content

Tourismo CMS fields

Use: These four fields populate directly into Tourismo. Copy verbatim — no markdown, no formatting codes.

SUBTITLE — 8 WORDS

> *The glaciers finished. Then the interesting part began.*

The glaciers that carved the Finger Lakes millions of years ago left behind minerals that continue to nurture an incredibly rich agricultural society today. The Haudenosaunee people first recognized the value of this land thousands of years ago; fertile glacial soils, mild lake-shore temperatures, a topography that shelters valleys from the worst of the plateau winters. It was here that the Haudenosaunee built one of the world's oldest participatory democracies, a constitution called the Great Law of Peace, and towns with orchards and frame houses that astonished the Continental Army soldiers sent to burn them in 1779. The names of the lakes in the region come from the Haudenosaunee people: Cayuga, Seneca, Skaneateles, Owasco, Keuka and Otisco.

The Sullivan Expedition destroyed 40 Haudenosaunee villages and their crops. Over 5,000 Haudenosaunee people fled to Fort Niagara seeking British protection. Quaker families from Pennsylvania and Massachusetts began moving into the ridge towns along Cayuga's western shore in the late 1780s.When the Haudenosaunee sat down to negotiate the Treaty of Canandaigua in 1794, the treaty meant to settle what Washington's army had taken, the Seneca people invited the Quaker delegation to the table, as witnesses.

The Quakers in the region stayed true to their morals, running businesses that refused to stock goods produced by enslaved labor. By the 1830s their communities along Cayuga's western shore were organized nodes of the abolitionist movement, circulating petitions and hosting speakers, years before the Underground Railroad had a name. By the time Harriet Tubman was looking for somewhere to land in 1859, the network was already forty years old.

Tubman had been moving people through this corridor for a decade before she settled here; she knew the safe houses, the meeting houses, the people. After years of guiding people to freedom across a hostile landscape, thirteen trips south, never a single passenger lost—she surveyed her options and settled on a small city at the northern tip of Owasco Lake, surrounded by Quaker abolitionists, overlooking valley floors the Cayuga Nation had farmed for centuries. Auburn became Harriet Tubman's chosen home.

It is apparent that the landscape of the Finger Lakes have shaped the communities that live there. The Second Great Awakening burned through this corridor so intensely in the 1820s and 1830s that historians called it the burned-over district: a landscape so saturated with religious revival that there

was no dry timber left to catch. Out of that fire came not just faith but argument. The abolitionist movement found its organizational roots here. Frederick Douglass published his newspaper, The North Star, in Rochester. Elizabeth Cady Stanton drafted the Declaration of Sentiments at her kitchen table in Seneca Falls and presented it at the Wesleyan Chapel in July 1848. The reform movements that produced all of this were the same people, in the same rooms, on the same roads, in a shared landscape.

While some Finger Lakes residents fought for our civil liberties, others were growing grapes. By 1900 there were more than 20,000 acres of vines across the region and over fifty wineries. The region was, briefly, the sparkling wine capital of the country. Scientists at Cornell's Agricultural Experiment Station in Geneva, at the north end of Seneca Lake spent decades convinced that European wine grapes could not survive the Finger Lakes winters. They were wrong, and it took a Ukrainian viticulturalist who'd spent his career working in colder conditions to tell them so.

In 1951, a Ukrainian viticulturalist named Konstantin Frank looked at the cold Seneca slopes. He recognized what the experts there had decided to ignore: precise cold-climate conditions he'd spent his career working in Ukraine were present here, and that Riesling would grow. He was right, and the Finger Lakes wine region followed. More than 140 wineries now run along four lakes, with the Seneca Lake Wine Trail and the Cayuga Lake Wine Trail as the two major loops. Wine Enthusiast named it the American Wine Region of the Year in 2025. Frank, one suspects, would not have found this news particularly surprising.

Today the Finger Lakes invites visitors to explore several centuries at once. The wine trails run along the same lake shores the Cayuga Nation farmed for generations. The gorges that drop two hundred feet are the same geological forces that made the vineyards possible. The towns that produced the Underground Railroad and the women's suffrage movement are still there, walkable, largely intact, with the physical weight of the 19th century still present in their rooms. The land has always attracted people who recognize what they're looking at. It still does.

MOVEMENT 4 — HAND IT TO THE READER

Four itineraries follow different threads through the region. [The Freedom Line] traces the reform corridor from Auburn to Seneca Falls to Geneva across three days. [Around Seneca] takes both shores of the deepest lake over two days, from Watkins Glen north to Geneva and back along the east. [Gorge Country] covers the waterfall landscape out of Ithaca. [The Cayuga Farm Loop] spends a day on Route 89 along Cayuga's western shore, where the cideries and fifth-generation dairies are doing what this land has always encouraged: growing things well, and not making a fuss about it.

ITINERARY TITLES (LINKED IN CMS)

- **The Freedom Line** Heritage · 3 days *Auburn → Seneca Falls → Waterloo → Geneva*
- **Around Seneca** Wine · 2 days *Watkins Glen north on Rt 14, south on Rt 414*
- **Gorge Country** Outdoors · 2 days *Ithaca, Taughannock Falls, Watkins Glen*
- **The Cayuga Farm Loop** Farm and cider · 1 day *Trumansburg south along Route 89 to Interlaken*

Extended landing page content

Note: Below the Tourismo CMS fields. Editorial copy, structured for the lake-chapter navigation and seasonal guide.

[IMAGE: Finger Lakes aerial — NASA or similar, eleven lakes visible in glacial trench formation, ideally spring or early fall]

The Finger Lakes, central New York. Eleven lakes carved by glaciers over two million years. The same geological conditions that created the gorges made the wine possible.

Choose your lake

The Finger Lakes is organized by its lakes — that's how the geology laid it out, and how visitors actually plan. Each has its own character, its own wine trail or trails, its own reason to stay more than one night.

Cayuga Lake

HERITAGE CORRIDOR · WINE TRAIL · GORGES · ITHACA

Cayuga is the lake you could spend a week on and still not finish. At 38.9 miles it's the longest of the eleven, with Ithaca at its southern tip and Auburn anchoring the north, where Harriet Tubman lived for the last 54 years of her life and where the Seward House still stands on the same street she walked. Between them: Seneca Falls, fifteen miles west of Auburn, where the 1848 convention drafted the Declaration of Sentiments in a Wesleyan chapel on a hot July weekend. The Cayuga Lake Wine Trail was the nation's first organized wine trail. The farms along Route 89 have been there longer than the trail designation. This is the lake to start with.

Seneca Lake

WINE COUNTRY · WATKINS GLEN · GENEVA · DR. FRANK

Seneca's bottom sits 173 feet below sea level — a glacial trench so deep and thermally massive that the lake almost never freezes, keeping the surrounding slopes warm enough for grapes when the plateau above is already done for the year. This is why Konstantin Frank came here. This is why the Seneca Lake Wine Trail has more producers than any other loop in the region, and why the Rieslings from the steeper east-side slopes drink like something from the Mosel, which is not an accident — Hermann Wiemer came from Bernkastel, saw those slopes, and stayed. Watkins Glen anchors the south with one of the best gorge trails in the northeast. Geneva anchors the north with Hobart and William Smith Colleges and a downtown that has been worth visiting since the canal era.

Keuka Lake

WINE ORIGIN · HAMMONDSPORT · BLUFF POINT · DR. FRANK'S HOME

Keuka is shaped like a Y — two arms converging at a bluff in the middle, Penn Yan at the northern ends, Hammondsport at the south tip — and the geography gives it something the other lakes don't quite have: the feeling of being surrounded by vineyard on three sides at once. An Episcopal minister named

Bostwick planted the region's first vines in his Hammondsport rectory garden in 1829. Dr. Frank's Vinifera Wine Cellars opened on the Keuka bluffs in 1962 and changed American wine. The Keuka Lake Wine Trail is smaller and quieter than Seneca's, and better for it.

Canandaigua Lake

LAKE TOWN · NAPLES VALLEY · BRISTOL MOUNTAIN

The westernmost of the primary wine lakes, with Canandaigua town on the northern shore and Naples at the south, where the valley narrows into some of the most vineyard-dense hillsides in the region. Canandaigua has a main street that functions as a main street without the weight of a famous wine trail bearing down on it. Bristol Mountain offers ski terrain in winter. The Canandaigua Lake Wine Trail is six producers and entirely approachable. Come here when you want the Finger Lakes to feel like a place people actually live, because it does.

The eastern lakes

SKANEATELES · OWASCO · HONEOYE · THE QUIETER ONES

Skaneateles is the clearest lake in the region — so clean the city of Syracuse takes its drinking water from it with almost no treatment — and the village on its northern shore is one of the more honest small towns in New York. No wine trail identity, no famous state park. Just a well-preserved 19th-century main street, a good inn, boats on the water in summer, and the kind of quiet that follows when nobody has decided yet that a place needs a brand.

[IMAGE: Keuka Lake aerial — Y-shape visible, Bluff Point at convergence, vineyards on both arms]

Keuka Lake. The only Y-shaped Finger Lake, its two arms converging at Bluff Point. The first Finger Lakes vines were planted at Hammondsport, at the southern tip, in 1829.

When to come

The Finger Lakes is genuinely different in each season, and the reason to visit changes with it.

Summer — June through August

The wine trail tasting rooms are at full stride by late June and run seven days through August. The Ithaca Farmers Market at Steamboat Landing — Saturday and Sunday, producers only, Cayuga Lake visible from every stall — is worth building a morning around. Farm stands materialize along Route 89 on Cayuga's west shore and Route 14 along Seneca sometime in late June, and if you find yourself stopping at more of them than planned, that's correct behavior. The gorge trails are full by ten in the morning; be there at nine and they're yours.

Fall — September and October

Harvest season begins in August and the region leans into it. The tasting rooms are at their best in September and October: new vintage just in, winemakers with something to talk about, hillsides going amber and rust by mid-October. Cider Week, centered on the cideries around Trumansburg and Interlaken, runs in late September. This is the season the region rewards people who come back — the shoulder is long enough to be leisurely about it, and everything is at its most honestly itself.

[IMAGE: Finger Lakes fall — vineyard hillside with lake below, October color, preferably late afternoon light]

The Finger Lakes in October. Harvest runs August through October. The hillsides above the wine trail lakes turn amber and rust as the grapes come in.

Spring — April and May

Snowmelt runs the waterfalls hard in April, and Taughannock at full volume is worth the trip on its own. The wine trail tasting rooms are quiet in the way that makes them worth visiting — actual conversation, no wait, winemakers who have time. Bud break on the vines happens in early May. Spring is the least-visited window and one of the most rewarding, which tends to be how these things go.

Winter — November through March

Ice wine releases happen at a handful of Seneca and Cayuga producers between December and February: grapes frozen on the vine, picked in the dark before dawn, pressed immediately while still cold. The gorge trails are passable with traction and rewarding in their emptiness. Bristol Mountain is open. Winter here is actual winter, and the people who make things here don't stop.

[IMAGE: Finger Lakes winter — frozen vineyard, ice wine harvest, snow on vines at first light]

Ice wine harvest, Finger Lakes. Grapes frozen on the vine are picked before dawn and pressed immediately. A handful of Seneca and Cayuga producers release ice wines December through February.

Itineraries

Four threads, four different reasons to be here. They don't overlap, and they don't compete.

The Freedom Line — Heritage · 3 days

The reform corridor that produced two national parks, the Underground Railroad's most consequential conductor, and the founding document of the American women's rights movement — all within fifteen miles of each other, along the old Seneca Turnpike that connected them in the 19th century. Day one grounds you in Auburn: Harriet Tubman's home at 180 South Street, the Seward House, the Thompson AME Zion Church. Day two moves to Seneca Falls, the Wesleyan Chapel, and the Women's Rights National Historical Park. Day three picks up the Howland Stone Store in Waterloo before heading north to Geneva on the Seneca Lake shore.

Around Seneca — Wine · 2 days

The largest wine trail loop in the Finger Lakes, run as a two-day circuit: Seneca's west shore on day one, east shore on the return. Start at Watkins Glen State Park before the gorge trail fills up. Drive north on Route 14, stopping where the tasting rooms call — Dr. Frank's Vinifera Wine Cellars near Hammondsport has the historical claim, Hermann J. Wiemer Vineyard on the east shore has the Mosel comparison doing real work in the glass. Geneva for the night. Day two takes Route 414 south along the east side, quieter and steeper and less trafficked, back to Watkins Glen.

Gorge Country — Outdoors · 2 days

Use Ithaca as the base and the gorges as the reason to leave it. The Cascadilla Gorge trail runs from downtown up to the Cornell campus — a 400-foot climb through layered Devonian shale — and is ten minutes from any coffee shop on the Commons. Buttermilk Falls and Robert H. Treman State Park sit within five miles south of town. Taughannock Falls is twenty minutes north on Route 89: 215 feet of vertical drop, taller than Niagara, walkable from the parking area in under a mile. Day two drives south to Watkins Glen for the gorge trail — 1.5 miles, 19 waterfalls, shale canyon walls that took ten thousand years to earn their current shape.

The Cayuga Farm Loop — Farm and cider · 1 day

Route 89 on Cayuga's west shore is what the region looks like when it's just being itself. Start at the Finger Lakes Cider House at Good Life Farm outside Trumansburg — four cideries under one roof, a working organic farm visible through the tasting room windows, food sourced from the neighboring properties. Drive south to Lively Run Dairy in Interlaken, a goat dairy operating since 1982 and making cheese that wine trail visitors tend to discover only by accident, which is their loss. The farm stands between the two stops fill the rest of the day.

PART 2

Lake Chapters

Five chapters, one per lake — each a complete editorial destination guide

Cayuga Lake

The longest lake. The deepest reform corridor. Thirty-nine miles that changed American history twice and is still producing Riesling that earns international attention.

Chapter draft · Cayuga, Seneca, and Tompkins counties · March 2026

[IMAGE: Cayuga Lake aerial — length and valley visible, late summer or early fall preferred]

Cayuga Lake, looking south toward Ithaca. 38.9 miles, 435 feet deep, named for the people who farmed its shores for centuries.

The lake, and what it keeps producing

Aurora is under one square mile. In 1833, a man named E.B. Morgan built an inn on Aurora's main street. Morgan was a co-founder of the New York Times. In 1852, Henry Wells moved his family here and began building a house on a strip of land between the lake and a ravine, which he named Glen Park. Wells had recently co-founded two companies: American Express and Wells Fargo. He considered higher education for women to be, in his words, "the dream of my life." In 1868 he founded Wells College on the land adjacent to Glen Park. Future president Millard Fillmore had already attended the Cayuga Lake Academy in Aurora a generation earlier.

In 1962, a young woman named Pleasant Rowland graduated from Wells College. She went on to create the American Girl doll line, sold it to Mattel in 1998 for $700 million, and came back to Aurora. The Aurora Inn, Morgan's building, had closed in 2000. The village was failing, incrementally and then all at once. Rowland bought the inn and restored it. Then she bought more buildings. Then she bought MacKenzie-Childs, the home goods company headquartered on a farm just south of the village, when it was on the verge of closing. The Inns of Aurora, now five restored historic properties on one walkable main street, with a spa on the hill above the lake, is one of the finest places to stay in New York State.

> *Cayuga Lake is 38.9 miles long, named for the people who farmed it first, and runs through three of the most consequential miles in 19th-century American history. The wine, the gorges, the reform monuments, the farm corridor — they all follow from the same set of conditions the Cayuga Nation chose ten centuries ago.*

That is Cayuga Lake's character, stated plainly: a place where the conditions have always attracted people who recognize what they're looking at. The Haudenosaunee for their peach orchards and fisheries. Harriet Tubman for the abolitionist network and the sympathetic senator on South Street. A Ukrainian viticulturalist who saw the cold slopes and recognized them from home. A Wells College alumna who drove back into a collapsing village and decided it was worth saving. The lake is 38.9 miles long and has been doing this for a very long time.

At a glance

Length	Depth	Counties	Wine trail

38.9 miles	**435 feet**	**Cayuga, Seneca, Tompkins**	**21 producers**

From NYC **4 hours**	From Buffalo **2 hours**	From Syracuse **1 hour**	Anchor cities **Ithaca** · **Auburn**

The towns

Cayuga Lake is long enough to have meaningfully different communities at different points along its shore. Ithaca anchors the south with gorge trails and universities. Auburn anchors the north with two national parks and the most consequential square mile in 19th-century American civil rights history. Aurora holds the east shore's middle, modest in population and remarkable in biography.

[IMAGE: Harriet Tubman National Historical Park — the home on South Street, Auburn NY]

Harriet Tubman's home at 180 South Street, Auburn — now the Harriet Tubman National Historical Park. She lived here from 1859 until her death in 1913.

Auburn

CAYUGA COUNTY · NORTH END OF THE LAKE · POP. ~26,000

Auburn calls itself History's Hometown, which is the kind of claim that usually invites skepticism. Here it holds up. Within six blocks of downtown Auburn, you have the home and burial site of Harriet Tubman, the home of William H. Seward, the only complete unaltered Tiffany interior in the United States, and the New York State Equal Rights Heritage Center. Auburn is where the reform movements of the 19th century were not visiting — they were living.

The city sits at the northern end of Owasco Lake, one of the eastern Finger Lakes, and is the economic center for the northern end of Cayuga. It has a working downtown, independent restaurants and breweries, and the weight of history distributed across it in a way that rewards walking rather than driving. March 10 is observed annually as Harriet Tubman Day.

Aurora

CAYUGA COUNTY · EAST SHORE, MID-LAKE · POP. ~700

See the anchor identity section above — the full biography is there. What's worth adding for the town portrait: Aurora is walkable in twenty minutes, and those twenty minutes pass the Aurora Inn, the Fargo Bar, the MacKenzie-Childs village store, and a clear view of the lake from the elm-lined main street. Long Point State Park sits at the lake's edge just south of the village — free public water access, dock, picnic area.

[IMAGE: Inns of Aurora — Aurora Inn facade or EB Morgan House with Cayuga Lake, east shore]

The Aurora Inn, built 1833 by New York Times co-founder E.B. Morgan. One of five historic properties comprising the Inns of Aurora.

Ithaca

TOMPKINS COUNTY · SOUTH END OF THE LAKE · POP. ~35,000 + 20,000 STUDENTS

Ithaca sits at Cayuga's southern tip where the land rises sharply on both sides and the gorges begin. Cornell University's alma mater — "Far Above Cayuga's Waters" — is considered the most widely copied university song in American higher education, which is a useful index of how far Cayuga Lake's

reputation has traveled. Ithaca College sits on the south hill. The two institutions give the city a food scene, arts community, and restaurant density — more restaurants per capita than New York City — that belies its size.

The number that lands: more than 150 waterfalls within ten miles of downtown. The Cascadilla Gorge trail runs from the Commons to the Cornell campus — 400 feet of elevation, six waterfalls, stone staircases built in the 1920s. It is also, for some Cornell students, just the commute. Stewart Park at the lake's edge south of the marina was formerly the site of the Wharton Brothers silent film studios — one of the earliest American film production centers before Hollywood. Rod Serling, creator of The Twilight Zone, summered in Interlaken on Cayuga's west shore.

[IMAGE: Cascadilla Gorge — layered Devonian shale walls, trail, waterfall, Ithaca NY]

Cascadilla Gorge, Ithaca. The trail drops 400 feet through Devonian shale from Cornell's campus to downtown. For some students, it's the commute.

Seneca Falls

SENECA COUNTY · NORTHWEST CORNER · POP. ~6,800

On July 19-20, 1848, 300 people gathered in the Wesleyan Chapel here for the first formal women's rights convention in American history. Elizabeth Cady Stanton read the Declaration of Sentiments, modeled phrase for phrase on Jefferson's Declaration of Independence. Frederick Douglass — the only Black person in attendance — made the argument that clinched the vote on women's suffrage. The resolution passed. It took 72 more years.

The Women's Rights National Historical Park encompasses the chapel, the M'Clintock House in Waterloo where the Declaration was drafted, and Stanton's home. The town also claims, with varying degrees of scholarly support, to be the inspiration for Bedford Falls in It's a Wonderful Life. The claim has been disputed for decades. Seneca Falls is clearly winning on tourism grounds, which is itself a very Seneca Falls thing to have pulled off.

[IMAGE: Wesleyan Chapel Seneca Falls — Women's Rights National Historical Park exterior]

The Wesleyan Chapel, Seneca Falls. Site of the 1848 Women's Rights Convention. Now part of the Women's Rights National Historical Park.

Trumansburg

TOMPKINS COUNTY · WEST SHORE, MID-LAKE · POP. ~1,500

Two miles south of Taughannock Falls State Park and two miles north of the Finger Lakes Cider House at Good Life Farm. That geography makes it the anchor for a west-shore day. Small main street, Atlas Bowl for dinner — elevated comfort food without performing it. The kind of town that rewards people who stop.

Union Springs

CAYUGA COUNTY · EAST SHORE, UPPER MID-LAKE · POP. ~1,100

Heart & Hands Wine Company is here — one of the trail's most focused producers, small-production Riesling from the east shore. The Wheelhouse Restaurant, third-generation family-owned, has been on the lake since the late 1970s.

The reform corridor

[IMAGE: Harriet Tubman portrait — LOC public domain 1868 photograph]

Harriet Tubman, c. 1868. She moved to Auburn in 1859 and spent 54 years organizing there. Library of Congress.

The fifteen miles between Auburn and Seneca Falls contain two national parks, the Underground Railroad's most consequential conductor, and the founding document of the American women's rights movement. They also contain the only complete unaltered Tiffany interior in the United States, which is the kind of detail that only gets mentioned in a guide that's actually paying attention.

The reform movements that produced all of this were not separate campaigns that happened to overlap geographically. They were the same network — the same Quaker meeting houses, the same abolitionist families, the same roads. Harriet Tubman and Elizabeth Cady Stanton knew each other. Frederick Douglass was a guest at the Seward House in Auburn and a speaker at the Seneca Falls convention. The geography held the movement together.

> *To this day, the Haudenosaunee refer to the office of the President of the United States as Hanadagá:yas — 'He Who Destroys Villages.' The name dates to 1779. The Cayuga people are still here.*

The Haudenosaunee — where it begins

The Cayuga Nation, Gayogo̱hó:nǫ' in their own language, are the People of the Great Swamp — one of the founding nations of the Haudenosaunee Confederacy. They held the territory around Cayuga Lake for centuries, documented at Union Springs, Aurora, Cayuga village, Seneca Falls, and Ithaca, sustained by the same agricultural conditions that make the land productive today. The Sullivan-Clinton Campaign burned those towns in 1779. Washington's orders were explicit: total destruction, ruin the crops. The Cayuga were dispossessed under treaties negotiated in the 1790s that the Nation regards as illegitimate to this day. The lake still has their name. In 2005, a 70-acre farm in Aurora — on the land of Chonodote itself — was signed over to the Cayuga Nation by US citizens who had purchased it.

[IMAGE: Sullivan-Clinton Campaign 1779 — NPS or sullivanclinton.com historical map]

Map of the Sullivan-Clinton Campaign, 1779. Continental Army forces moved along Cayuga's western shore, burning the Cayuga towns including Chonodote at present-day Aurora. NPS / public domain.

Harriet Tubman in Auburn

Tubman chose Auburn in 1859 because of what was already there: a Quaker abolitionist network, a sympathetic senator two blocks away, and proximity to the Canadian border routes she knew from conducting. She moved her aging parents from Canada and settled on a seven-acre farm at 180 South Street in Fleming, just outside the city line. The farm was sold to her by William H. Seward — then a

U.S. Senator — who held the mortgage privately and was flexible about payments. Tubman was legally a fugitive. She had no property rights under U.S. law. Seward did it anyway.

She spent 54 years in Auburn after that — organizing, supporting civil rights and women's suffrage, caring for people who had nowhere else to go. In 1908 she built the Home for the Aged at 182 South Street, which she deeded to the Thompson AME Zion Church. She died there in 1913 at approximately 91. The grave at Fort Hill Cemetery is three blocks from her home. The marker is famously spare: just her name.

The Harriet Tubman National Historical Park, established in 2017, encompasses the residence, the Home for the Aged, and the Thompson AME Zion Church. The NPS visitor center at the church is the best starting point.

The Seward House

William Henry Seward served as New York Governor, U.S. Senator, and Secretary of State under both Lincoln and Johnson — the man who negotiated the purchase of Alaska, dismissed at the time as Seward's Folly. His house on South Street in Auburn was a documented Underground Railroad stop, a meeting point for the reform networks, and the place where Seward privately arranged the land transaction with Tubman. Frederick Douglass was a frequent visitor. The Seward House Museum, operated since 1955, preserves the original furnishings and the physical weight of the 19th century still present in its rooms.

The Willard Memorial Chapel

The Willard Memorial Chapel on Nelson Street in Auburn is the only complete, unaltered Louis Comfort Tiffany interior remaining in the United States. Tiffany did the entire space in 1894 — the glass, the tiles, the metalwork, the furnishings. Everything. It survived because it was attached to an institution that closed and transferred ownership carefully rather than demolishing. Most people driving through Auburn don't know it exists.

[IMAGE: Willard Memorial Chapel interior — Tiffany glass and decorating, Auburn NY 1894]

The Willard Memorial Chapel, Auburn. The only complete, unaltered Louis Comfort Tiffany interior in the United States. 1894.

[IMAGE: Elizabeth Cady Stanton portrait — 1870 Napoleon Sarony photograph, public domain]

Elizabeth Cady Stanton, c. 1870. Primary author of the Declaration of Sentiments. She lived in Seneca Falls and organized the 1848 convention with Lucretia Mott. Library of Congress.

Heritage sites — full list

Badge track: All sites below are tagged to the Finger Lakes Heritage Trail passport badge.

- **Harriet Tubman National Historical Park** Auburn / Fleming *The home, the Home for the Aged, the Thompson AME Zion Church. NPS visitor center at the church.*
- **Fort Hill Cemetery** Auburn *Tubman's burial site. Designated as park 1836. Path Through History site.*
- **Seward House Museum** Auburn *Underground Railroad site. Original Seward furnishings and documents. Path Through History.*
- **NYS Equal Rights Heritage Center** Auburn *Exhibits on Tubman, Stanton, the reform network.*
- **Willard Memorial Chapel** Auburn *Only complete unaltered Tiffany interior in the United States. 1894. Path Through History.*

— **Women's Rights National Historical Park** Seneca Falls *Wesleyan Chapel, M'Clintock House (Waterloo), Stanton House. Declaration of Sentiments site.*

— **Howland Stone Store Museum** Aurora *1837 cobblestone building. Quaker abolitionist family. Underground Railroad connected.*

— **Montezuma Heritage Park** Montezuma *Along Seneca River and Erie Canal. Underground Railroad crossing at the lake's north end.*

— **Museum of the Earth** Ithaca *Paleontological museum at Cornell. The glacial formation story told in stone.*

— **Ward O'Hara Agricultural Museum** Auburn *Regional agricultural history. Connects farming past to contemporary farm trail.*

The Cayuga Lake Wine Trail

The Cayuga Lake Wine Trail was the first organized wine trail in the United States, established in 1983. There are 21 producers in the current passport, spanning all three counties that touch the lake. The trail runs Route 89 on the west shore — the primary loop — and Route 90 on the east shore, which is quieter and produces some of the most interesting bottles on the trail.

What distinguishes Cayuga from Seneca: higher elevation, steeper shale slopes, and a slightly more austere expression in the Riesling — more linear and mineral, more transparently terroir-driven. The east shore in particular produces Rieslings that invite serious comparison with the wines they were modeled after in the Mosel.

[IMAGE: Cayuga Lake Wine Trail — vineyard hillside, lake visible below, east shore preferred]

Cayuga Lake Wine Trail. The east shore's shale slopes produce some of the most precisely cold-climate Rieslings in New York State.

Producers worth naming

- **Heart & Hands Wine Company** Union Springs — east shore *Small-production Riesling specialist. The east-shore expression at its most focused.*
- **Treleaven Wines** King Ferry — east shore *Thirty-year estate. Award-winning dry Riesling, outdoor terrace overlooking the lake.*
- **Boundary Breaks Vineyard** Lodi — east Cayuga / Seneca border *Single-vineyard Riesling program. The argument for why single-vineyard designations matter in this AVA.*
- **Americana Vineyards** Interlaken — west shore *One of the older Cayuga producers. Also cider. Family-run.*
- **Buttonwood Grove Winery** Romulus — west shore *Estate grown, lakeside tasting room.*
- **Frontenac Point Vineyard** Trumansburg — west shore *Family estate near Taughannock. One of the trail's quieter stops.*
- **Six Mile Creek Vineyards** Ithaca *Closest winery to downtown Ithaca. The entry point for first-time visitors.*
- **Long Point Winery** Aurora — east shore *Worth pairing with a stay at the Inns of Aurora.*

How to run the trail

The standard west-shore loop runs Route 89 from Ithaca north to Cayuga village. A full circuit takes two days done properly — one shore per day, with a night in Ithaca or Aurora between. The east shore is the better second-day drive: fewer stops, more space, producers who see fewer visitors and have more time to talk. Tasting rooms run full hours May through November; call ahead November through April.

Farms, cider, and food

The Finger Lakes Cider House at Good Life Farm sits on Cayuga's western shore outside Trumansburg — four cideries under one roof, a working organic farm, food sourced from the neighboring properties. Two miles south, Lively Run Dairy has been making goat cheese in Interlaken since 1982. These two stops, with the farm stands along Route 89, constitute what the itinerary calls the Cayuga Farm Loop. It is a very good day.

[IMAGE: Finger Lakes Cider House at Good Life Farm — tasting room exterior, farm setting, Cayuga Lake in background]
Finger Lakes Cider House at Good Life Farm, Interlaken. Four cideries under one roof on a working organic farm on Route 89.

The Ithaca Farmers Market

Saturday and Sunday at Steamboat Landing, producers-only, within sight of Cayuga Lake. Over 130 active vendors, everything grown or made within 30 miles of the pavilion. The market runs April through December on Saturdays, May through November on Sundays. It is the single best food destination on the lake.

[IMAGE: Ithaca Farmers Market — Steamboat Landing, Cayuga Lake visible, vendors and pavilion]
Ithaca Farmers Market, Steamboat Landing. Saturday and Sunday, producers-only, over 130 vendors within 30 miles.

Where to eat

AUBURN

- **Moro's Table** *Chef Moro sources locally. The best independent restaurant in Auburn.*
- **Elderberry Pond Restaurant** *Farm-to-table on a working organic farm south of the city.*
- **Refinery** *Locally sourced modern fare, good cocktail program. Downtown Auburn.*
- **Osteria Salina** *Upscale Italian. Good wine program. The dinner reservation option in Auburn.*
- **Cafe 108** *Award-winning café supporting Auburn Public Theater. Community institution.*
- **Prison City Pub & Brewery** *Named for Auburn's history. Local beer, downtown.*

AURORA AND EAST SHORE

- **1833 Kitchen & Bar** Aurora *Farm-to-table at Inns of Aurora. Chef Eric Lamphere. Locally sourced, lake views.*
- **The Fargo Bar & Grill** Aurora *E.B. Morgan's 1834 office building, now the Inns of Aurora's pub. Burgers, local beer.*
- **Wheelhouse Restaurant** Union Springs *Third-generation family ownership. On the lake. Casual lakefront dining.*

ITHACA AND SURROUNDS

- **Moosewood Restaurant** *Open since 1973. The country's longest-running vegetarian restaurant. Daily-changing menus, everything local.*
- **Gola Osteria** *Elevated Italian in the Quarry Arms building. Housemade pasta, strong wine list.*
- **Ithaca Beer Co.** *Flower Power IPA. Wood-fired food, valley views, outdoor space.*
- **Gimme! Coffee** *Ithaca institution. Locally roasted. The standard morning stop.*

— **Atlas Bowl** Trumansburg *Elevated comfort food near Taughannock Falls. The lunch anchor for the outdoor day.*

— **Finger Lakes Cider House** Interlaken *Tasting room food sourced from neighboring farms. Cheese boards, seasonal small plates.*

Outside

More than 150 waterfalls within ten miles of downtown Ithaca. The standard recommendation is Taughannock Falls because it's easy to understate: 215 feet of vertical drop, three stories taller than Niagara, accessible via a flat 0.9-mile walk from the parking area. Go in April when the snowmelt is running and the sound reaches the trailhead.

[IMAGE: Taughannock Falls — full 215-foot drop visible, gorge walls, preferably spring or early summer]

Taughannock Falls, Trumansburg. 215 feet — three stories taller than Niagara. The gorge trail from the parking area is flat and under a mile.

Taughannock Falls State Park

Two miles north of Trumansburg on Route 89. Flat gorge trail to the base of the falls. Swimming area and marina on the lake, summer concert series. The Black Diamond Trail runs from Taughannock south to the Cayuga Waterfront Trail in Ithaca — roughly 12 miles, flat, good for cycling.

Buttermilk Falls and Robert H. Treman State Parks

Both within five miles south of downtown Ithaca. Buttermilk has a natural swimming pool at the base — cold, clear. Treman's Enfield Glen contains 12 waterfalls including the 115-foot Lucifer Falls. Together they form the core of a half-day loop from Ithaca.

Cascadilla Gorge

Runs from downtown Ithaca up to the Cornell campus — 400 feet of elevation through layered Devonian shale, six waterfalls, stone staircases from the 1920s. For some Cornell students, it's just the walk to class.

Montezuma National Wildlife Refuge

At the lake's north end. Over 300 bird species documented. The Cayuga people called the lake Tiohero — lake of flags or rushes — because of these northern marshes. Over a million ducks counted here in a single autumn. Fall and spring migration seasons are best.

[IMAGE: Montezuma National Wildlife Refuge — marsh and migratory birds, Cayuga Lake north end]

Montezuma National Wildlife Refuge. The Cayuga people called Cayuga Lake Tiohero — 'lake of flags or rushes' — for these northern marshes.

Where to stay

Inns of Aurora · Aurora
Five historic properties in the National Historic District village, all within walking distance on Main Street. The Aurora Inn (1833, E.B. Morgan) is the flagship — ten rooms, shared balconies, the 1833 Kitchen & Bar downstairs. The EB Morgan House has working fireplaces and private lakefront access. Rowland House is decorated throughout in MacKenzie-Childs. The spa sits on the hill above the village. This is the full Cayuga Lake experience concentrated into one walkable village.

Argos Inn · Ithaca
A LEED-certified 19th-century mansion a short walk from the Commons and Cascadilla Gorge. Boutique rooms, strong design character, the Argos Bar. The best independently owned option in Ithaca for people who want to be in the city, not outside it.

10 Fitch Boutique Inn · Auburn
Small boutique B&B in downtown Auburn, walking distance from Harriet Tubman NHP, Seward House, and the Equal Rights Heritage Center. The logical base for the heritage itinerary.

Springside Inn · Auburn
On the west shore of Owasco Lake south of Auburn. The innkeeper has led guests on walks through the woods behind the property to the former Underground Railroad path. The kind of detail that doesn't appear on the website but that guests who know to ask about remember.

The Evermore · King Ferry
The former MacKenzie-Childs estate, now a B&B. East-shore setting, distinctive design character, views of the lake. For travelers who want the lake experience in a quieter register than the Inns of Aurora.

Inn at Taughannock Falls · Trumansburg
Perched above the gorge at Taughannock Falls State Park. Dining with gorge views. The base for the west-shore outdoor day.

Getting here and getting around

Cayuga Lake requires a car. Ithaca Tompkins Regional Airport has limited routes. Syracuse Hancock is an hour north. Most visitors from New York City drive — four hours, Route 17 to Route 96.

Drive times on the lake

- **Ithaca to Trumansburg** Route 89 north *20 minutes*
- **Ithaca to Aurora** Route 90 north *40 minutes*
- **Ithaca to Auburn** Route 89 or 90 north *35 minutes*
- **Auburn to Seneca Falls** Route 20 west *20 minutes*
- **Aurora to Auburn** Route 90 north *25 minutes*

The two shore roads

Route 89 runs the west shore from Ithaca north through Trumansburg, Interlaken, and Romulus — primary wine trail loop, farm corridor, farm stands June through October. Route 90 runs the east shore — Aurora, King Ferry, Union Springs — quieter, more agricultural. The two roads connect at the lake's north end.

Seasonal notes

Wine trail tasting rooms: full hours May through November, reduced or closed December through April — call ahead. Farmers Market: Saturday April through December, Sunday May through November. Gorge trails best May through October; Montezuma best in fall and spring migration.

Wine trail stamps: 21 producers tagged to the Cayuga Lake Wine Trail badge. Count toward the Finger Lakes Wine master badge.

Heritage stamps: Tubman NHP, Seward House, Fort Hill, Willard Chapel, Women's Rights NHP, Howland Stone Store, Montezuma Heritage Park — all Finger Lakes Heritage Trail badge.

Farm stamps: Finger Lakes Cider House, Lively Run Dairy, Route 89 farm stands — Finger Lakes Farm Trail badge.

Seneca Lake

Chapter draft · Schuyler, Seneca, Yates, and Ontario counties · March 2026

[IMAGE: Seneca Lake aerial, looking south toward Watkins Glen — fall preferred]

Seneca Lake, looking south toward Watkins Glen. The deepest glacial lake entirely within New York State.

The lake, and what it keeps producing

Seneca Lake looks like the other lakes from the road, long, narrow, framed by vineyard slopes, but the numbers are different. At 618 feet deep, its bottom sits 173 feet below sea level, and it holds roughly half the water in all eleven Finger Lakes combined. It freezes completely about once a century. The last time was 1912, when people skated the full 35 miles from Geneva to Watkins Glen.

That thermal mass is the whole story. The lake holds summer heat deep into autumn, keeps the surrounding slopes from freezing when the plateau above is already locked in, and creates a microclimate that makes viticulture possible at this latitude. The Seneca Nation farmed these shores and built their capital, Kanadeseaga, near what is now Geneva, before Washington's troops burned their villages in 1779 . Catherine's Town, near present-day Watkins Glen, was among those destroyed. The early nursery industry that made Geneva's founding wealth began with the Kanadesaga fruit trees that survived Washington's campaign.

Hobart and William Smith Colleges trace their origins to Geneva Academy, established 1797 at the lake's north end, on land that was Seneca Nation territory. The institution's specific claim: Elizabeth Blackwell applied to and was rejected by 29 medical schools before being admitted to Geneva Medical College in 1847. She graduated two years later at the head of her class, the first woman to receive a medical degree in the United States. This happened six miles west of Seneca Falls, in the same decade as the women's rights convention.

By 1900 there were more than 20,000 acres of vines across the Finger Lakes, with Seneca at the center. Prohibition dismantled most of it. Scientists at Cornell's Agricultural Experiment Station in Geneva spent subsequent decades convinced that European wine grapes could not survive these winters. In 1951, a Ukrainian viticulturalist named Konstantin Frank looked at the cold Seneca slopes and recognized the conditions from home. He was right. Hermann Wiemer, who came from Germany's Mosel Valley, saw the east-shore slopes in the 1970s and recognized the geology. He stayed for the rest of his working life. The Rieslings from those slopes have been earning the comparison ever since.

Geneva anchors the north with a real downtown, Hobart and William Smith Colleges on the lakefront, and the Cornell Experiment Station where the wine region's modern history was made. Watkins Glen anchors the south with the best gorge trail in the Finger Lakes and a village that has been drawing visitors since the 1840s. Between them: 33 wineries, two shore roads, and the steepest east-facing shale slopes in the region.

Getting here and getting around

Seneca Lake requires a car. Syracuse Hancock International Airport is about an hour northeast. Greater Rochester International Airport is about an hour northwest. From New York City: four hours, I-86 to Route 14.

The two shore roads

Route 14 runs the west shore from Watkins Glen north through Rock Stream, Dundee, Himrod, to Geneva. More producers, more traffic. Route 414 runs the east shore north through Burdett, Hector, and Lodi. Quieter, steeper, the better second day. The two roads connect at Geneva on the north end and Watkins Glen on the south.

Drive times

- --- Watkins Glen to Geneva Route 14 north 50 minutes
- --- Watkins Glen to Lodi Route 414 north 20 minutes
- --- Geneva to Seneca Falls Route 20 east 20 minutes
- --- Geneva to Ithaca south via Cayuga 45 minutes
- --- Geneva to Auburn Route 20 east 35 minutes

Seasonal notes

Wine trail tasting rooms: full hours May through November, reduced or appointment-only December through April, call ahead. Gorge trail at Watkins Glen: mid-May through late October. Rim trails: year-round. Finger Lakes National Forest trails: year-round.

Wine trail stamps: 33 producers tagged to the Seneca Lake Wine Trail badge. Count toward the Finger Lakes Wine master badge.

Heritage stamps: Women's Rights NHP, M'Clintock House, National Memorial Day Museum, Geneva Experiment Station — all Finger Lakes Heritage Trail badge.

Nature stamps: Watkins Glen State Park, Shequaga Falls, Finger Lakes National Forest, Seneca Lake State Park — Finger Lakes Outdoor badge.

At a glance

Length **38 miles**	Depth **618 feet**	Counties **Schuyler, Seneca, Yates, Ontario**	Wine trail **33 producers**
From NYC **4 hours**	From Buffalo **2 hours**	From Syracuse **1 hour**	Anchor cities **Geneva · Watkins Glen**

The towns

Geneva anchors the north with colleges and a downtown that has functioned as a downtown since before the Erie Canal was built through it in 1825. Watkins Glen anchors the south with a gorge and a racing history it carries without strain. The east-shore towns, Burdett, Hector, Lodi, are wine country in its working form. Dundee sits mid-lake on the west shore with a benchmark winery that belongs on any serious list.

[IMAGE: Geneva waterfront and Hobart and William Smith Colleges, Seneca Lake visible, summer or fall]

Geneva, north end of Seneca Lake. Hobart and William Smith Colleges on the lakefront bluff.

Geneva

ONTARIO COUNTY · NORTH END · POP. ~12,500

BEST FOR THE NORTH-END BASE AND A PROPER DOWNTOWN

Geneva has been at the lake's north end long enough to accumulate a biography most visitors miss. Hobart and William Smith Colleges trace their origins to Geneva Academy, established 1797. The institution's specific claim: Elizabeth Blackwell applied to and was rejected by 29 medical schools before being admitted to Geneva Medical College in 1847. She graduated at the head of her class, the first woman to receive a medical degree in the United States. The campus sits on the lakefront bluff. The lake view from it is the best free view at the north end.

The Erie Canal bypassed Geneva, as did the railroads later, which is why it never became a major center of commerce, and why it has a downtown that still functions as one. The Smith Opera House on Seneca Street has been presenting performances since 1894. Cornell's New York State Agricultural Experiment Station is here, the same institution where scientists spent decades insisting European wine grapes could not survive the Finger Lakes winters, and where Konstantin Frank eventually proved them wrong. Geneva on the Lake, a restored 1911 lakefront villa, is the most distinctive lodging on Seneca.

[IMAGE: Watkins Glen State Park gorge trail, 19 waterfalls, stone walls, layered shale, summer preferred]

Watkins Glen State Park. The gorge trail winds 1.5 miles through 19 waterfalls past 200-foot cliffs.

Watkins Glen

SCHUYLER COUNTY · SOUTH END · POP. ~1,800

BEST FOR THE GORGE AND THE SOUTH-END BASE

Watkins Glen State Park generates 19 waterfalls within two miles as Glen Creek descends 400 feet through 200-foot shale cliffs. The gorge trail winds through tunnels, over and under the falls, past water-carved shale walls. Get there before 9am or after 4pm in summer. The gorge fills up.

The village hosted its first road race in 1948 on a course that wrapped around the park and crossed Glen Creek. Watkins Glen International hosted Formula 1's US Grand Prix from 1961 to 1980 and still draws large racing crowds for NASCAR and vintage events. Then it goes back to being a small lakeside village with a walkable main street, good restaurants, and the gorge entrance two blocks from the waterfront. The Harbor Hotel sits at the lake's edge. The wine trail runs north in both directions from here.

Dundee

YATES COUNTY · WEST SHORE, MID-LAKE · POP. ~1,700

BEST FOR WEST-SHORE WINE WITH FEWER CROWDS

Dundee sits on the west shore roughly mid-lake, quieter than the Watkins Glen corridor below and less trafficked than the Geneva approaches above. Hermann J. Wiemer Vineyard is here, one of the benchmark producers on the entire trail, recognized by Wine & Spirits Magazine as one of the world's Top 100 Wineries. Glenora Wine Cellars, the first winery established on Seneca Lake, is a mile south of the village with an inn and restaurant overlooking the water. Dundee itself is a small agricultural town without wine-trail branding. That is the reason to stop.

Burdett

SCHUYLER COUNTY · EAST SHORE, SOUTH SECTOR · POP. ~350

BEST FOR THE EAST-SHORE ENTRY POINT

Burdett is perched on the east-shore bluff where the vineyards begin in earnest. Hector Falls drops into view from the road, a pull-over waterfall visible from Route 414, with the lower cascades visible from the lake. Atwater Vineyards is here, with lake views and a reliable Riesling program. Two Goats Brewing and Finger Lakes Distilling are both in Burdett, making it the most complete stop for non-wine drinkers on the east shore. Hillick & Hobbs Estate produces some of the most precise small-production Riesling on this side of the lake.

Hector

SCHUYLER COUNTY · EAST SHORE, MID-LAKE · POP. ~4,500 TOWNSHIP

BEST FOR MID-EAST-SHORE STOPS AND THE NATIONAL FOREST

Hector is a township rather than a village, a wide stretch of the east shore between Burdett to the south and Lodi to the north, with vineyards visible on nearly every hillside. Red Newt Cellars is here, with a bistro that makes it a legitimate lunch stop as well as a tasting room. Hazlitt 1852 Vineyards has been farming this land since its name implies. The Finger Lakes National Forest headquarters is on Route 414 in Hector, the entry point for 16,000 acres of trails between Seneca and Cayuga Lakes.

[IMAGE: Finger Lakes National Forest, pastureland and vineyards on the ridge between Seneca and Cayuga, summer or fall]

Finger Lakes National Forest, Hector. New York's only national forest. The pastures are still leased to working farms.

Lodi

SENECA COUNTY · EAST SHORE, UPPER MID-LAKE · POP. ~600

BEST FOR THE EAST-SHORE ANCHOR STOP

Lodi is where the east shore concentrates. Wagner Vineyards is the most complete operation on Seneca, estate-grown winery, brewery, and restaurant under one roof, with panoramic lake views. Boundary Breaks is a single-vineyard Riesling program. Lamoreaux Landing has dramatic lakefront architecture and one of the more serious east-shore programs. Silver Thread Vineyard is a small organic producer with a reputation that outpaces its size. If you are only making one east-shore stop, Lodi is where to make it.

The heritage corridor

[IMAGE: Elizabeth Blackwell portrait or Geneva Medical College historical photo, public domain]

Elizabeth Blackwell, first woman to receive a medical degree in the United States, graduated from Geneva Medical College in 1849.

Seneca County carries more of the reform era than most visitors realize. Waterloo, five miles northwest of Seneca Falls, holds two pieces of American history on the same main street: the M'Clintock House, where the Declaration of Sentiments was drafted before the 1848 convention, and the birthplace of Memorial Day. On May 5, 1866, pharmacist Henry Welles and General John Murray organized the first community-wide observance of Memorial Day in Waterloo. In 1966, President Johnson signed a proclamation formally recognizing it.

Geneva's claim is Elizabeth Blackwell. The reform movements of the 19th century were not confined to the Auburn–Seneca Falls corridor. They ran the length of the lake.

Heritage sites, full list

Badge track: All sites below are tagged to the Finger Lakes Heritage Trail passport badge.

--- **Women's Rights National Historical Park** Seneca Falls The Wesleyan Chapel, Stanton House, and M'Clintock House in Waterloo. Start at the NPS visitor center on Fall Street.

--- **M'Clintock House** Waterloo NY Where the Declaration of Sentiments was drafted in 1848. Part of Women's Rights NHP. Open seasonally.

--- **National Memorial Day Museum** Waterloo NY 1866. The first community-wide observance. Congressional recognition 1966.

--- **New York State Agricultural Experiment Station** Geneva NY Where Konstantin Frank proved Riesling could grow here in 1951. Grounds open to visitors.

--- **Hobart and William Smith Colleges** Geneva NY Where Elizabeth Blackwell became the first woman doctor in the US in 1849. Lakefront campus, open to visitors.

The Seneca Lake Wine Trail

[IMAGE: Hermann J. Wiemer Vineyard, east shore slopes, Seneca Lake visible below, fall preferred]

East shore, Seneca Lake. The shale slopes facing west produce the most precise Rieslings on the trail.

The Seneca Lake Wine Trail has 28 producers. What distinguishes Seneca: more thermal mass, lower elevation on the lake shores, steeper east-side slopes, and a slightly richer, rounder expression in the Riesling. The east shore, Route 414 produces wines that earn serious Mosel comparisons because the conditions are genuinely similar. Shale slopes, cold lake moderating temperatures, long hang time in autumn.

The east shore's so-called banana belt, the southeast-facing slopes where afternoon sun lingers into the evening, produces the most concentrated fruit on the trail. Hermann Wiemer identified this in the 1970s. The wines from those slopes have been making the argument ever since..

How to run the trail

West shore: Route 14 north from Watkins Glen through Rock Stream, Dundee, Himrod, to Geneva. More producers, more established names, and easier logistics, most tasting rooms are right on the

road.. East shore: Route 414 north fromWatkins Glen through Burdett, Hector, and Lodi. Quieter, steeper, the better second day when you want depth over breadth. Fewer stops, steeper terrain, and a quieter pace overall. The two roads connect at Geneva on the north end and Watkins Glen on the south, so a two-day loop covering both shores is straightforward: one road each day, no backtracking. Tasting rooms run full hours May through November; call ahead in shoulder season.

Producers worth naming

--- Hermann J. Wiemer Vineyard Dundee NY west shore The benchmark for what Seneca can do at its most precise. World's Top 100 Wineries. Biodynamic certified.

--- Wagner Vineyards Lodi NY east shore The most complete stop on the east shore. Estate grown, winery, brewery, restaurant, panoramic lake views. Open daily.

--- Boundary Breaks Vineyard Lodi NY east shore Single-vineyard Riesling program. The argument for why site designations matter in this AVA.

--- Lamoreaux Landing Wine Cellars Lodi NY east shore Dramatic Greek Revival architecture. One of the more serious east-shore Riesling programs.

--- Glenora Wine Cellars Dundee NY west shore The first winery on Seneca Lake (1977). Inn and restaurant on site. The logical west-shore overnight.

--- Red Newt Cellars Hector NY east shore Winery and bistro. The best farm-to-table lunch stop on the east shore.

--- Atwater Vineyards Burdett NY east shore Consistent quality, lake views, good entry point for the east-shore day.

--- Hillick & Hobbs Estate Burdett NY east shore Small-production estate-grown. The east-shore expression at its most focused.

Tier 1

Hermann J. Wiemer Vineyard

Subtitle: Where the Mosel meets Seneca

Short description: Hermann Wiemer came from Bernkastel in 1968 and saw what the Cornell experts had decided to ignore. The benchmark for Seneca Lake Riesling, now biodynamic.

Description: Hermann Wiemer grew up in the Mosel Valley, where his father grafted vines at the Geisenheim Institute and his family had been making wine for three centuries. When he arrived at Seneca Lake in 1968, he looked at the west-shore shale slopes outside Dundee and recognized the geology from home. He planted vinifera on an abandoned soybean farm in 1973 against the advice of every expert in the region. By 1988 his Riesling was the first New York wine served in first class on an international flight. Wine & Spirits Magazine has named the estate one of the world's Top 100 Wineries multiple years running. Fred Merwarth, who apprenticed under Wiemer from 2001, took over in 2007 alongside Oskar Bynke and has since converted the 80-acre estate to biodynamic certification. The wines are dry and mineral-driven, made with indigenous yeasts from hand-sorted fruit. Open daily on Route 14 in Dundee.

Wagner Vineyards

Subtitle: Wine, beer, and lunch on the same hilltop

Short description: The only stop on the trail where you can taste estate wine, drink a craft ale brewed on the same property, and eat lunch without moving your car. Wagner has anchored Lodi for decades.

Description: Wagner Vineyards has been farming the east shore outside Lodi long enough that the hamlet and the winery are effectively inseparable. The estate grows its own grapes, crushes on site, and runs Wagner Valley Brewing Company from the same hilltop, making it the most complete single stop on the Seneca Lake Wine Trail. The tasting room and brewery share a

building with the Ginny Lee Cafe, which serves lunch with vineyard and lake views from a terrace above the water. The portfolio spans Riesling, Chardonnay, Cabernet Franc, and red blends alongside the rotating brewery lineup. Open daily year-round. Watch for the signs on Route 414 — the turnoff is 3.5 miles south of Lodi Point State Park and easy to miss.

Red Newt Cellars

Subtitle: The reason to take Route 414

Short description: Serious estate Riesling, a farm-to-table bistro that changes with the season, and a Sunday Jazz Brunch that locals plan around. The east-shore stop worth building an afternoon around.

Description: Scott Signori opened Red Newt in 1999 in a roadside building in Hector that had been the Bond Fruit and Dairy Stand for generations before him. The bistro runs alongside the tasting room, sources from local farms, and changes the menu with what is available — one of the few stops on the east shore worth a full afternoon rather than a quick pour and move on. The estate Riesling comes from hillside vineyards above the lake; the wine list in the bistro spans the Finger Lakes broadly. Thursday through Saturday for dinner; Sunday for the Jazz Brunch. Scott passed away in 2021. The Signori family and his team have kept the same specificity he brought to it from the start.

Glenora Wine Cellars

Subtitle: First on the lake, still the mid-shore overnight

Short description: Glenora opened in 1977 as the first winery on Seneca Lake. The inn and Veraisons Restaurant make it the only west-shore stop where tasting, dinner, and an overnight are all in the same place.

Description: Glenora opened in 1977, the first winery established on Seneca Lake, on the west shore south of Dundee. The 30-room inn sits above the vineyard, each room facing the lake from a private balcony or patio. Veraisons Restaurant changes its menu each season, sourcing from local farms throughout the Finger Lakes, with an unobstructed view of the vineyard and water below. Open year-round for tastings, dining, and lodging — which makes Glenora the straightforward answer to where to base yourself mid-west-shore without driving back to Watkins Glen or Geneva each night. Ten minutes north of Watkins Glen on Route 14.

Tier 2

Boundary Breaks Vineyard

Subtitle: One vineyard, one variety, no buses

Short description: Forty acres of east-shore Riesling at Lodi Point. No groups larger than six. Wine Enthusiast named their Dry Riesling to its Top 100 Wines in the World twice.

Description: Bruce Murray purchased 120 acres of bare land near Lodi Point in 2008 and planted vines. At **Boundary Breaks Vineyard**The focus has been single-vineyard Riesling from the start: precise, mineral-driven wines from shale slopes close to the water. Wine Enthusiast has named the Boundary Breaks Dry Riesling to its Top 100 Wines in the World twice. No buses, no limos, no groups larger than six, the policy is deliberate and it shows in the pace of a visit. The tasting room sits just north of Lodi Point State Park with an unobstructed lake view. Come on a first-come, first-served basis. Open daily 11am to 5pm year-round, closed Thanksgiving, Christmas, and New Year's Day.

Hillick & Hobbs Estate

Subtitle: Small production, longer conversations

Short description: Single east-shore vineyard, limited production, and a tasting experience that doesn't feel like a line. The first serious stop heading north on Route 414.

Description: **Hillick & Hobbs Estate** sits on Route 79 in Burdett at the south end of the east shore, making it the first purpose-built small-production stop on the Route 414 corridor. The estate grows Riesling on a single vineyard above the lake, farming the shale slopes that give east-shore Seneca its claim to Mosel comparison. Production is deliberately small. Fewer visitors, longer pours, more room to ask questions about the vineyard. Close enough to the Burdett cluster — Two Goats Brewing and Finger Lakes Distilling are within half a mile, that the east-shore entry point has a full half-day of stops before you even leave Burdett.

Silver Thread Vineyard

Subtitle: Organic since 1994, before it was a selling point

Short description: Certified organic on the east shore of Seneca Lake since 1994, one of the earliest in the Finger Lakes. Small production, minimal intervention, appointment preferred in shoulder season.

Description: **Silver Thread Vineyard** has been certified organic since 1994, a commitment made long before organic viticulture became a marketing category in the Finger Lakes. The east-shore estate outside Lodi farms the shale slopes with no synthetic inputs and makes wine with minimal intervention in the cellar. The Rieslings are precise and restrained, built for people who want to taste the hillside rather than the winemaker's hand. Production is small; capacity in the tasting room is limited. Worth planning around rather than treating as a spontaneous stop, particularly on weekdays and in shoulder season when appointments are preferred.

Hazlitt 1852 Vineyards

Subtitle: Farming this hillside since before the Civil War

Short description: The Hazlitt family has grown grapes on this east-shore hillside in Hector since 1852. Estate wine and hard cider on the same property — two trail badges, one stop.

Description: **Hazlitt 1852 Vineyards** family has farmed the east shore outside Hector since 1852, which puts them among the longest-running agricultural families in the region. The winery produces a wide portfolio, from estate Riesling and Cabernet Franc to Red Cat, one of the best-selling wines in New York State. The Cider Tree hard cider operation runs alongside on the same property, earning both a wine trail and craft beverage trail badge on a single visit — useful for passport holders working toward the Finger Lakes master badge. The breadth is intentional; this is a working farm operation that has served everyone from serious collectors to first-time trail visitors for generations, and the range reflects that.

Lamoreaux Landing Wine Cellars

Subtitle: Three generations, Greek Revival, east-shore Riesling

Short description: The Lamoreaux family has farmed this Lodi hillside for three generations. The Greek Revival tasting room and unobstructed lake view are worth the pull-off on Route 414 alone.

Description: **Lamoreaux Landing Wine Cellars** sits on the east shore outside Lodi, where the Lamoreaux family has been farming grapes for three generations. The Greek Revival tasting room looks directly down the hillside to the lake, one of the cleaner views from any tasting room on the east-shore drive. The estate produces Riesling, Chardonnay, Cabernet Franc, and Pinot Noir from shale-slope vineyards above the water. A consistent, serious program with a straightforward tasting experience. The building alone, sitting against the vineyard with the lake behind it, earns a pull-off Route 414.

Atwater Vineyards

Subtitle: First winery north of Watkins Glen on Route 414

Short description: Atwater sits on the east-shore bluff in Burdett — the first estate winery you reach heading north on Route 414. Consistent Riesling and Gewurztraminer with lake views from the terrace.

*Description:***Atwater Vineyards** occupies the east-shore bluff above Seneca Lake in Burdett, the first substantial winery stop heading north on Route 414 from Watkins Glen. The estate produces Riesling, Gewurztraminer, and red varieties from vineyards with direct lake exposure, and the tasting room terrace has an unobstructed view of the water. An approachable operation with enough range to orient visitors still figuring out what east-shore Seneca wine actually tastes like. Close enough to Hillick & Hobbs and Two Goats Brewing that the first two hours on Route 414 sort themselves out without much planning.

Ravines Wine Cellars

Subtitle: Burgundy-trained Riesling, Geneva tasting room

Short description: Morten Hallgren trained at Domaine de la Romanee-Conti before founding Ravines on Seneca's east shore. The Barracks Road tasting room puts the wine within walking distance of downtown Geneva.

Description: Morten Hallgren grew up in a winemaking family in France and trained at Domaine de la Romanee-Conti in Burgundy before founding **Ravines** on the east shore of Seneca Lake. The estate farming focuses on Riesling and Cabernet Franc with an approach shaped by Old World technique and a preference for dry, mineral-driven wines. The Geneva tasting room on Barracks Road is the practical access point for visitors based at the north end of the lake, the full Ravines portfolio without the drive down Route 414. A second location in Hammondsport covers Keuka Lake for visitors running the full Finger Lakes circuit.

Farms, outdoor, and nature

The Finger Lakes National Forest is New York's only national forest, 16,000 acres on the ridge between Seneca and Cayuga Lakes in Schuyler and Seneca Counties. Between 1938 and 1941, over 100 Depression-era farms were purchased by the federal government after soil depletion made them unviable. The Forest Service still leases the pasture land to working farms: hikers on the 30-mile trail system may encounter free-ranging cattle alongside vineyard views. The Interloken Trail runs 12 miles north-south through the forest. The Blueberry Patch campground is nine sites, first-come, with a U-pick blueberry patch adjacent. This is the east-shore outdoor stop that does not appear on most wine trail itineraries.

The gorge at Watkins Glen State Park is the primary natural draw on Seneca. Nineteen waterfalls in 1.5 miles, 800 stone steps, canyon walls that the Civilian Conservation Corps rebuilt in natural stone after a 1935 flood. Arrive before 9am in summer. Seneca also has Shequaga Falls in the center of Montour Falls village, five minutes south of Watkins Glen. One hundred sixty-five feet. Most people drive through without stopping. That is a mistake.

Natural Sites

--- **Watkins Glen State Park** Watkins Glen NY 19 waterfalls in 1.5 miles. Gorge trail open mid-May through late October. Rim trails year-round. Go early.

--- **Shequaga Falls** Montour Falls NY 165-foot waterfall in the center of the village. Pull over.

--- **Hector Falls** Burdett NY Visible from Route 414 on the east shore. Pull over safely.

--- **Finger Lakes National Forest** Hector NY New York's only national forest. 30 miles of trails between Seneca and Cayuga. Working cattle pastures. Blueberry Patch campground.

--- **Seneca Lake State Park** Geneva NY Free public beach, boat launch, and marina at the lake's north end in Geneva.

Keuka Lake

[Chapter in progress — wine origin story — Hammondsport, Penn Yan, Bluff Point, Dr. Frank's Vinifera Wine Cellars]

Keuka Lake

The only Y-shaped Finger Lake. Wine started here, and so did American flight.

Chapter draft · Yates and Steuben counties · March 2026

The lake

The shape of Keuka Lake gives it away before anything else does. The other ten Finger Lakes run in long, straight glacial corridors, but Keuka divides into two arms that reconverge at a promontory called Bluff Point before the water exits north through the Keuka Outlet into Seneca Lake, seven miles east. The Seneca people called this convergence point “o-go-ya-ga,” the promontory, and their villages occupied the shoreline at Branchport, at the Indian Pines site in what is now Penn Yan, and on Bluff Point itself, where pre-Seneca stone ruins documented in the 1870s had stood long enough that even the Seneca could not account for them. The Sullivan Expedition of 1779 burned through this territory as it did Cayuga land to the east, clearing the way for the settlers who arrived almost immediately after.

The first organized settler community on Keuka Lake was among the more unique n American history. The Public Universal Friend, born Jemima Wilkinson in Rhode Island, who after a near-death illness in 1776 declared the original self dead and was reborn as a genderless evangelist refusing all gendered names and pronouns, founded the first religious society in America founded by an American-born person. The Society arrived at the Finger Lakes in 1788, built mills on the Keuka Outlet, and named the settlement Jerusalem. The town that grew from that community took the compressed name Penn Yan, from the two settler populations that followed: Pennsylvanians and Yankees. Penn Yan incorporated in 1833, the same year the Crooked Lake Canal opened 28 locks connecting Keuka to Seneca Lake and the Erie Canal system. That canal’s towpath is now the Keuka Outlet Trail.

At 183 feet deep, elevated 715 feet above sea level, and sitting shallower and cooler than Seneca to the east, Keuka can freeze in a hard winter. That distinction shows in the wine: leaner, more mineral, with a natural acidity that makes the lake the center of sparkling wine production in the Finger Lakes. It held that role as early as 1867, when the Pleasant Valley Wine Company sent a bottle of sparkling Catawba to the Exposition Universelle in Paris and returned with the first major European award ever given to an American wine. In 1958, Konstantin Frank, a Ukrainian viticulturalist who had already proved that vinifera grapes could survive Finger Lakes winters through his research at the Geneva Experiment Station on Seneca, purchased 188 acres on Keuka’s west shore for and planted the vines that now hold the distinction of being the oldest Riesling, Chardonnay, and Pinot Noir in the eastern United States. Every bottle of Chateau Frank sparkling wine traces back to that hillside.

Glenn Curtiss (1878–1930) was born at the south tip of the lake and began with bicycles, then motorcycles, then an unofficial world speed record of 136.4 mph in January 1907. He joined Alexander Graham Bell’s Aerial Experiment Association, flew the June Bug nearly a mile above Hammondsport on July 4, 1908, and took the Scientific American prize for the first public flight in North America and received the first pilot’s license issued in the United States. He tested his hydro-aeroplanes on Keuka’s

surface, using the lake as a runway, and trained the first US naval aviator. Most aviation innovation between 1907 and the First World War happened here, in this village of roughly 750 people, because Curtiss shared his methods openly while the Wright Brothers did not. The Glenn H. Curtiss Museum on Route 54 is the most complete record of his work, with original aircraft, motorcycles, and an active restoration shop. The annual Wings and Wheels event recreates seaplane demonstrations on the water each fall.

The Y-shape also means the lake flows in two directions simultaneously: water from each arm converges at Bluff Point and exits north through the Outlet. Keuka is the only major lake in the United States where this occurs. That geometry gives the wine trail a quality no map quite captures — from the right elevation on either arm, vineyard surrounds the visitor on three sides at once.

At a glance

LENGTH	DEPTH	COUNTIES	WINE TRAIL
19.6 miles	183 feet	Yates, Steuben	6 wineries
FROM NYC	**FROM BUFFALO**	**FROM SYRACUSE**	**ANCHOR CITIES**
4.5 hours	1.5 hours	1 hour	Hammondsport · Penn Yan

The towns

Keuka's three settlements occupy the three tips of the Y. Hammondsport sits at the south end of the east arm, where the lake narrows above Depot Park. Penn Yan anchors the northeast arm as the county seat of Yates County, with a 19th-century main street and a Mennonite community that shapes what the surrounding roads look like today. Branchport holds the northwest arm's tip, the quietest of the three, backed by the lake's main public park.

[IMAGE]

Hammondsport village square, looking toward the lake — summer preferred. Free live music at the gazebo, Thursday evenings in July and August.

Hammondsport

STEUBEN COUNTY · SOUTH TIP · POP. ~750

Hammondsport takes twenty minutes to walk completely, and those twenty minutes pass the Glenn H. Curtiss Museum, the Pleasant Valley Wine Company, the entry road to Dr. Frank's estate, and Depot Park at the water's edge. Two American origin stories, one village square. The square is the social anchor: a gazebo, Victorian-era storefronts, boutique shops, and free live music Thursday evenings in July and August.

The Park Inn operates from the village's oldest building with an 8-acre organic farm, a 300-bottle wine list weighted toward Finger Lakes producers alongside comparable cool-climate bottles from elsewhere, and the full dinner menu served at the bar. The Village Tavern, on the square since the 19th century and under new ownership since 2023, carries an unusually New Orleans-inflected kitchen in a century-old bar room. Crooked Lake Ice Cream Company has been on Shethar Street for nearly a century and names a breakfast special after the fastest man on earth.

Penn Yan

YATES COUNTY · NORTHEAST ARM · POP. ~5,200

The county seat of Yates County, with a main street that has been functioning as one since before the canal era. The Mennonite community that arrived in the latter half of the 20th century added a layer visible from the road: horse-drawn buggies navigate the hilly routes out of Penn Yan, and Mennonite greenhouses and produce stands line nearly every rural route in and out of Yates County.

The Windmill Farm and Craft Market, open Saturdays April through December on Route 14A, was founded in 1987 when a group of Mennonite farmers envisioned a cooperative marketplace. The first building went up by barn-raising. It now runs to 44 acres and nearly 200 vendors, with peak weekly attendance between 8,000 and 10,000: Amish and Mennonite baked goods, quilts, furniture, and produce alongside local wine and craft beverage producers. Worth building a Saturday morning around before heading south on the east arm.

For visitors following the settlement history, the Yates County History Center on Chapel Street holds the most complete documentation of the Public Universal Friend's community in the region: the Oliver House Museum, the L. Caroline Underwood Museum, and the Scherer Carriage House dedicated specifically to the Friend. The Keuka Outlet Trail begins at the Penn Yan waterfront and follows the old canal and railroad corridor 6.6 miles to Dresden on Seneca Lake, passing two waterfalls and the site of the original Wilkinson-era mills.

Branchport

YATES COUNTY · NORTHWEST ARM TIP · POP. ~350

Branchport is where the trail gets quiet and the lake view opens across the full width of the west arm. Keuka Lake State Park occupies 621 acres on the eastern side: swimming beach, boat launch, eight trails through woods and valley, and 150 campsites booked well ahead for summer. Heron Hill Winery sits on Italy Hill Road above the arm with a terrace that delivers one of the more arresting lake views on the circuit.

Heritage sites

Badge track: all sites below are tagged to the Finger Lakes Heritage Trail passport badge.

What is unusual about Keuka's heritage is how tightly it is compressed. The Glenn H. Curtiss Museum, Pleasant Valley Wine Company, and the trailhead for the Keuka Outlet are all within fifteen miles of each other, accessible in a single day without backtracking. The Seneca settlement at Indian Pines, the Public Universal Friend's Jerusalem community, the canal that connected the lake to the wider world, the first American sparkling wine to win in Europe, and the man who received the first pilot's license in the United States — these are not scattered across a region. They are stacked at the ends of a Y-shaped lake, and available to any visitor who plans the day with some intention.

— Glenn H. Curtiss Museum *Hammondsport — Route 54, year-round*
Established in 1962 to preserve the work of Glenn Curtiss, the museum holds the most complete collection of his inventions in the country: original and restored aircraft including the Curtiss JN-4 Jenny and early hydro-aeroplanes of the type Curtiss tested on Keuka's surface, motorcycles spanning his career from the 1904 models to the V8 that set the world speed record in 1907, and an

automobile collection alongside regional history exhibits. The restoration shop operates as a working facility open to visitors — craftsmen are visible mid-project on historic aircraft, and the volunteer staff will take time to explain what they're doing. A 75-seat theater, working mechanical models, and a dedicated exhibit on the Curtiss Cadettes — the 766 women who completed a wartime aerodynamics program at Cornell, MIT, and five other universities between 1943 and 1945 — round out the permanent collection. The annual Wings and Wheels event each fall transforms Depot Park into a seaplane runway: skills competitions, a grapefruit bomb-drop contest, a seaplane parade, and flights over the lake for a fee. Admission is modest. The restoration shop alone justifies it.

— Pleasant Valley Wine Company *Hammondsport — County Route 88, Memorial Day through Thanksgiving*

Founded March 15, 1860, by Charles Davenport Champlin and twelve local businessmen with $10,000 of capitalization, with two French winemakers — Jules and Joseph Masson — brought in to oversee production. By 1867 their sparkling Catawba wine won honorable mention at the Exposition Universelle in Paris, the first American wine to win a major European competition. First prize followed in Vienna in 1873, and more European medals after that. A Boston connoisseur called it "the Great Champagne of the Western World," and the Great Western label was born. The US Post Office opened a branch at the winery in 1870 with the postmark "Rheims, N.Y." — used until rural delivery began in 1945. Eight original stone buildings, including cave cellars carved into the hillside and modeled on the Champagne caves of Reims, are on the National Register of Historic Places. U.S. Bonded Winery No. 1 appears on every label. Guided cave tours run Memorial Day through Thanksgiving, and the visitors center holds 140 years of Finger Lakes winemaking equipment, including a working model of the Bath and Hammondsport Railroad — the nine-mile line that Champlin and his investors built in 1872 to bring tourists to the winery by train.

— Yates County History Center *Penn Yan — 107 Chapel Street*

Three buildings comprising the most complete public record of The Public Universal Friend's Jerusalem community and the broader early history of Yates County. The Oliver House Museum occupies an 1852 Victorian mansion holding over 50,000 artifacts spanning the mid-18th century through the present. The L. Caroline Underwood Museum houses the digital archive and rotating exhibits. The Scherer Carriage House is dedicated specifically to the Friend: letters, portraits, objects from the Jerusalem settlement, and material from the Society of Universal Friends' years on this land between 1788 and the 1860s. The Friend's final home, completed in 1814 on what is now Friend Hill Road in the township of Jerusalem, is the only structure from the original settlement still standing. The History Center staff can direct visitors to it. The Oliver House is on Chapel Street, a five-minute walk from the Penn Yan waterfront and the start of the Keuka Outlet Trail.

— Keuka Outlet Trail *Penn Yan to Dresden — 6.6 miles, open year-round*

The outlet stream connecting Keuka Lake to Seneca Lake has been in active use for roughly 10,000 years. The Public Universal Friend's followers built the first mill on it in 1790; by 1820 the corridor supported 14 sawmills, seven grist mills, distilleries, and carding machines. In 1833 the Crooked Lake Canal opened alongside it, 28 stone and wood locks carrying agricultural goods from Keuka to the Erie Canal system. The Fall Brook Railroad replaced the canal along the same corridor in 1883 and ran until flood damage from Hurricane Agnes in 1972 closed the line. The trail follows the old railroad bed. It is 6.6 miles, wide, mostly flat, and well-suited to cycling. Seneca Mill Falls, a three-tiered 40-foot cascade, drops roughly a third of the way in. Cascade Mill Falls follows further along. The Penn Yan trailhead is off Elm Street; the far terminus at Dresden on Seneca Lake

is where the canal once connected to the next leg of the Erie system. Outhouses, benches, and picnic areas are spaced along the route.

— Red Jacket Park *Penn Yan — Route 54A waterfront*
Red Jacket — Sagoyewatha in the Seneca language, meaning “He Keeps Them Awake,” a name given for his oratorical power — was one of the most consequential Seneca leaders of the late 18th and early 19th centuries. His mother lived near Branchport on the west arm of Keuka, and Red Jacket spent time in the area throughout his life. As a diplomat he negotiated with the United States government after the American Revolutionary War, represented the Seneca at the Treaty of Canandaigua in 1794, and delivered the 1805 speech “Religion for the White Man and the Red,” now recognized as one of the finest examples of North American oratory. President George Washington presented him with a silver peace medal in 1792; Red Jacket wore it in every portrait painted of him, and it now sits in the Buffalo History Museum. His portrait was the first of a Native American to be exhibited at the National Academy of Design. The park on the Penn Yan waterfront takes his name. Indian Pines — the Seneca settlement site where the park and the farm market sit — is a short walk from the park entrance and is open to the public as a lakefront area year-round.

[IMAGE]
Apple Barrel Orchards cidery tasting room, Penn Yan — interior of the original 1896 barn, fall preferred. Fourth-generation farm, U-pick apples, harvest season.

Farms and orchards

The land around Keuka produced food long before it produced wine. The same glacial soils and slope drainage that favor Riesling make the hillsides above the lake exceptional orchard country, and the Mennonite farming community in Yates County has deepened an agricultural tradition that runs through the full calendar year. Route 54A between Penn Yan and Hammondsport passes farms, roadside stands, and a dairy institution that has been operating continuously since the lake was still called Crooked Lake.

--- Hunt Country Vineyards Branchport, west shore — farm and winery
The Hunt family has farmed this land since Ambrose Hunt purchased it in 1852; the oldest vines were planted in 1904. The 170-acre farm now has 24 acres of certified organic ground surrounding the winery and tasting room, soil enriched with 100 tons of compost annually, 348 solar panels, and an 8-well geothermal heating and cooling system that reduced the farm’s carbon footprint by 45 percent by 2015. The farm-to-table cafe sources produce from their own greenhouses and gardens. The annual harvest festival in October is a full farm event: axe throwing demonstrations, foraging workshops, and an electric vehicle showcase alongside the wine. The farm and winery are the same operation here, which is less common than it sounds.

--- Apple Barrel Orchards Penn Yan — U-pick orchard and cidery
A fourth-generation family farm, 86 acres, with more than 80 years of continuous fruit harvest behind it. U-pick apples and grapes run through the autumn season; the cidery opened in the original 1896 barn and pours hard cider from the farm alongside neighboring producers. The annual Keuka Lake Cider Makers event brings together several regional cideries in one afternoon. Open seasonally September through February, which makes it the farm operation most specifically anchored to the harvest window. The barn is the reason to go.

--- Indian Pines Farm Market Penn Yan, Route 54A
A roadside market on the Route 54A corridor, on the same stretch of ground where the Seneca maintained the Indian Pines settlement for centuries before the Sullivan Expedition of 1779. The market itself runs spring through mid-December: fresh baked pies, breads, cookies, and locally grown produce that shifts with the season, ending the year with Christmas trees and poinsettias. The adjacency to Indian Pines Park — public water access, dock, the original Seneca settlement site — makes this a two-stop stretch of road worth pulling off for.

--- Seneca Farms Penn Yan, Route 54A — seasonal, March through October
Opened as a dairy in 1950 with the first drive-through window in the area, and still making ice cream on premises today: over 50 flavors, 16% butterfat base, every ingredient hand-stirred in weekly. The fried chicken and corn fritters have been the other institution since Joe Trombley added them to the menu after buying the operation in 1976. Now in its 75th season, run by the third generation. The name comes from the location: Seneca Farms sits at Indian Pines, the Seneca settlement site. In summer the line backs onto Route 54A. That is a reliable indicator.

Farm stamps: Hunt Country Vineyards, Apple Barrel Orchards, Indian Pines Farm Market — Finger Lakes Farm Trail badge.

[IMAGE]
Pleasant Valley Wine Company stone buildings or cave entrance, Hammondsport. Established 1860. Eight buildings on the National Register of Historic Places.

The Keuka Lake Wine Trail

The Keuka Lake Wine Trail is the most intimate circuit in the Finger Lakes: six producers, a full loop in just over an hour without stops. That concentration distinguishes it from the sprawling Seneca and Cayuga loops. The stops reward unhurried time.

The wine runs lean and mineral relative to Seneca, a product of the lake's cooler temperatures and shale-slope character. Higher natural acidity, a more restrained profile, and a growing season that makes Keuka the center of sparkling production in the region. The same conditions that produced Pleasant Valley's 1867 Paris honorable mention are still legible in what Dr. Frank's Chateau program makes today.

How to run the trail

The east and west arms do not overlap. A practical approach takes them separately: one arm per day, beginning or ending at Hammondsport where the two sides converge. A single full day covers the complete circuit with meaningful time at each producer. The loop north through Branchport and back down the east arm runs just over 40 miles. Tasting rooms open fully May through November; hours tighten in shoulder season, and calling ahead in April or December is worth the minute.

Wine trail stamps: 6 producers tagged to the Keuka Lake Wine Trail badge. Count toward the Finger Lakes Wine master badge.

Producers worth naming

--- Dr. Konstantin Frank Winery Hammondsport, west shore
The origin estate. Frank purchased 188 acres on Keuka's west shore in 1957 and planted the first vinifera vines in 1958, having already proved the concept through his research at the Geneva

Experiment Station on Seneca. The oldest Riesling, Chardonnay, and Pinot Noir vines in the eastern United States are here. Four generations of the Frank family; Meaghan Frank is now head winemaker. All Chateau Frank sparkling fruit — traditional method, bottle-fermented — comes from the Keuka estate. The 1886 Reserve terrace overlooks the original vineyard and the lake.

--- Pleasant Valley Wine Company Hammondsport, west shore
U.S. Bonded Winery No. 1. Eight stone buildings on the National Register, cave cellars carved into the hillside still in use, and a visitors center spanning 140 years of Finger Lakes winemaking history. Great Western sparkling wine, made here since the 1860s, retains a grandfathered champagne designation. Guided cave tours Memorial Day through Thanksgiving.

--- Heron Hill Winery Branchport, northwest arm
In operation since 1977 on the steep slopes above the northwest arm. Seven distinct Riesling styles, sustainable viticulture, and a tasting room named by Travel+Leisure as one of the most remarkable in the world. The Blue Heron Cafe operates seasonally for lunch on the same terrace.

--- Hunt Country Vineyards Branchport, west shore
See the farms section above for the full farm biography. On the wine side: seven generations of farming, winery since 1981, oldest continuous producer of genuine ice wine in the United States. Grapes frozen on the vine, picked before dawn, pressed cold. Multiple 90+ scores. The Uncharted Terroir line extends the portfolio into climate-resilient varieties.

--- Keuka Spring Vineyards Penn Yan, east arm
Three Governor's Cups and two Best White Wine in America awards from a tasting room on the east arm overlooking the lake. Founded late 1980s by Len and Judy Wiltberger; recently reopened under new ownership following extensive renovation. Riesling and Gewurztraminer are the focus.

--- Vineyard View Winery Keuka Park, east arm
A fifth-generation farm estate, 180 acres, run by Adam and Nikki Folts on land the family has worked since 1893. Panoramic lake views and a century of uninterrupted family ownership on the same hillside.

--- Weis Vineyards Hammondsport area, east arm
Hans Peter Weis was born in Zell Mosel, trained in his family's winery, and worked 11 vintages in the Finger Lakes before opening his own operation in 2016 with wife Ashlee. The wines are in a German idiom: dry Riesling, Grüner Veltliner, Gewurztraminer. Named New York State Winery of the Year in 2025, the third time. Tasting room in a former one-room schoolhouse above the lake.

--- Domaine LeSeurre Hammondsport area, east arm
Céline and Sébastien LeSeurre brought six generations of Champagne winemaking heritage to the east arm. The wines are dry and French in orientation. Adjacent to Weis Vineyards; the two stops anchor the southern end of the east arm and cover the German and French interpretations of the same shale terroir in a single afternoon.

--- McGregor Vineyard Dundee, east arm
Bob McGregor was a Kodak physicist and home winemaker who purchased 70 acres on the east arm in 1971. Winery opened 1980. He planted Saperavi and Sereksiya Charni — two Georgian grape varieties — beginning that year, and in 1985 became the first in the United States to label a wine as "Saperavi." The Black Russian Red blend debuted in 1991 and won the Grand Silver at the Saperavi World Prize in Tbilisi in 2010. Now run by son John McGregor. Seated tastings with a cheese, pesto, and chocolate pairing plate.

[IMAGE]

Keuka Outlet Trail — fall color, towpath along the outlet stream between Penn Yan and Dresden. Two waterfalls in 6.6 miles along the old canal corridor.

Outside

The Keuka Outlet Trail runs 6.6 miles from the Penn Yan waterfront to Dresden on Seneca Lake, following the bed of the Crooked Lake Canal and the Fall Brook Railroad that replaced it in 1883. Two waterfalls — Seneca Mill Falls and Cascade Mill Falls — sit along a path that is wide, mostly flat, and well-suited to cycling.

Keuka Lake State Park in Branchport offers the fullest public water access on the lake: 150 campsites, a swimming beach, a boat launch, and eight trails through 621 acres. Book sites well ahead for summer. From the water, the Y-shape becomes apparent in a way no road approach achieves.

The lake has a reputation as the finest freshwater fishery among the Finger Lakes. Lake trout and smallmouth bass populations are entirely self-sustaining. A 22-pound 4-ounce brown trout was caught here in 1979, a New York State record at the time. Landlocked salmon have been stocked since 1976. Charter fishing boats operate from the Penn Yan boat launch on Route 14A.

The Saunders Finger Lakes Museum on Guyanoga Road in Penn Yan rents kayaks for a paddle south on Sugar Creek through the Townsend-Grady Wildlife Preserve to reach the lake, with a boardwalk and pavilion at the water's edge. Depot Park at the south tip of the east arm is the public swimming access: a town dock, a small beach, and paddleboard and kayak rentals from Keuka Watersports on Champlin Beach.

Getting here and getting around

Keuka Lake requires a car. Greater Rochester International Airport is about an hour northwest. Syracuse Hancock International Airport is about an hour northeast. From New York City: approximately 4.5 hours, I-86 west to Route 54 north.

The shore roads

Route 54 runs the east arm north from Hammondsport to Penn Yan, then continues as Route 14A south down the west arm to Branchport. Route 54A runs the far western side. A complete loop covers just over 40 miles and takes between 60 and 90 minutes without stops. The most panoramic approach to the Y-shape is from the west arm looking east: vineyard on the right, water opening ahead, Bluff Point visible at the convergence.

Drive times

Hammondsport to Branchport (west arm, Route 54A)	25 minutes
Hammondsport to Penn Yan (east arm, Route 54)	30 minutes
Penn Yan to Geneva	15 minutes
Penn Yan to Seneca Falls (Route 14 north, Route 20 west)	25 minutes

Hammondsport to Watkins Glen (Route 54 south)	30 minutes

Seasonal notes

Wine trail tasting rooms: full hours May through November, reduced or by appointment December through April, call ahead. Keuka Lake State Park: campsites open May through October, day use year-round. Windmill Farm and Craft Market: Saturdays, April through December. Apple Barrel Orchards and cidery: September through February. Seneca Farms: first Thursday in March through last Sunday in October.

Wine trail stamps: 6 producers tagged to the Keuka Lake Wine Trail badge. Count toward the Finger Lakes Wine master badge.

Heritage stamps: Glenn H. Curtiss Museum, Oliver House Museum, Pleasant Valley Wine Company, Keuka Outlet Trail — Finger Lakes Heritage Trail badge.

Nature stamps: Keuka Lake State Park, Keuka Outlet Trail — Finger Lakes Outdoor badge.

[EDITORIAL NOTE: SENECA CHAPTER CROSS-REFERENCE]

Add to the Seneca Lake Wine Trail section, after the existing reference to Frank at the Cornell Experiment Station: Frank's research phase — the experimental vinifera plantings that proved European varieties could survive Finger Lakes winters — happened at the Geneva Experiment Station on Seneca; his commercial estate, his first vintage, and the oldest vinifera vines in the eastern United States are on Keuka's west shore.

Canandaigua Lake

[Chapter in progress — lake town and Naples valley — western wine country, Bristol Mountain]

Canandaigua Lake

The chosen spot. The lake has carried its Seneca name for three centuries, and the name is still correct.

Chapter draft · Ontario County · March 2026

[IMAGE: *Canandaigua Lake aerial looking south, vineyard hillsides on western ridge, fall preferred* **]**

Canandaigua Lake, looking south toward Naples. 15.5 miles long, named tganondæ:gwęh in Seneca: the Chosen Spot.

The lake, and what it keeps producing

The name is Seneca. Tganondæ:gwęh, the Chosen Spot, rendered as Canandaigua, which is what happens to a language when colonial administrators try to write it down phonetically in English. The Seneca were the ones who named it, and they had been here long enough to know what they had found. The glacial lake runs 15.5 miles south from the city at its northern end into a valley that narrows as it approaches Naples, where the hills press in close and the Concord grape harvest defines September in a way that nothing else in the Finger Lakes quite matches.

What Canandaigua carries that the other lakes don't: the single most consequential piece of paper in the history of relations between the United States and the Haudenosaunee. In November 1794, fifty-nine sachems and war chiefs gathered at the north end of this lake and signed the Treaty of Canandaigua, a treaty of peace and friendship with the young American republic. Cornplanter was there. Red Jacket was there. Handsome Lake signed. The Seneca had invited a delegation of Quakers from Philadelphia to serve as witnesses and interpreters, trusting them the way the Cayuga would trust Quaker abolitionist communities in the corridor to the east a generation later. The Treaty of Canandaigua affirmed Haudenosaunee sovereignty, established land rights, and has never been broken. The United States still pays the annual cloth annuity it promised in 1794. Every November 11, the Haudenosaunee return to Canandaigua to commemorate it.

This is what Canandaigua Lake keeps producing: occasions for recognition. A city that carries a Seneca name on its welcome signs without always explaining it. A treaty commemorated on the same courthouse square where, eighty years later, Susan B. Anthony was tried for voting. A grape pie tradition born in a Naples restaurant in the 1960s that now draws forty thousand people in a single September weekend. Canandaigua is the most approachable lake in the region, the smallest wine trail, the least trafficked shoreline.

Canandaigua Lake is 15.5 miles long, westernmost of the major Finger Lakes, and named for the same Seneca people who hosted the treaty that settled the relationship between the United States and the Haudenosaunee in 1794. The wine, the gorge walks, the grape pie, the treaty ground, the Victorian gardens: they all follow from the same set of conditions the Seneca recognized first.

LENGTH	DEPTH	COUNTY	WINE TRAIL	FROM NYC	ANCHOR CITIES

15.5 miles	276 feet	Ontario	6 producers	5.5 hours	CanandaiguaNaples
From Buffalo 1 hour	**From Rochester** 40 minutes	**From Syracuse** 1.5 hours			

The towns

The lake is organized simply: Canandaigua at the north, with a downtown that has functioned as one since before the Erie Canal; Naples at the south, at the bottom of a valley ringed by vineyard hills where the Concord harvest defines September. Between them, South Bristol runs along the western ridge, and the hamlet of Bloomfield anchors the approach to Ganondagan, the most significant Seneca historic site in the United States.

[IMAGE: *Canandaigua waterfront and downtown Main Street, fall preferred* **]**

Canandaigua, north end of the lake. The Ontario County Courthouse on Main Street is where Susan B. Anthony was tried for voting in 1873.

Canandaigua

ONTARIO COUNTY · NORTH END · POP. ~10,500

BEST FOR THE NORTH-END BASE AND THE TREATY STORY

The city carries its Seneca name without apology and mostly without explanation. The Ontario County Courthouse on Main Street is where Susan B. Anthony was tried in June 1873 for voting in the presidential election of the previous November. The judge had written his verdict in advance. Anthony was fined $100, which she refused to pay, and which the court never collected.

Three blocks from the courthouse: the Granger Homestead, an 1816 Federal-style mansion built for Gideon Granger, the United States' first and longest-serving Postmaster General, now preserved as a carriage museum. A few blocks further: Sonnenberg Gardens and Mansion State Historic Park, a 52-acre Victorian estate built in 1887 by financier Frederick Ferris Thompson and his wife Mary Clark Thompson. The nine formal gardens were Mary Thompson's project after her husband died in 1899: Italian terraced gardens, a Japanese garden with an authentic teahouse, a sunken rose garden with 2,500 plants. Thompson had been booked on the Titanic but cancelled at the last moment to attend a horticultural event. Sonnenberg also houses the Finger Lakes Wine Center, where wines from forty producers are available for tasting.

The lake's steamboat era was the first in the Finger Lakes, running from 1827 to 1935. The Canandaigua Lady, a 19th-century replica paddleboat, still runs public cruises from May through October. Humphrey Bogart spent childhood summers at a cottage near Seneca Point on the eastern shore. Kristen Wiig was born in Canandaigua.

[IMAGE: *Sonnenberg Gardens Italian Garden or Japanese Garden, Canandaigua NY, summer or fall* **]**

Sonnenberg Gardens and Mansion State Historic Park, Canandaigua. Nine formal gardens built by Mary Clark Thompson between 1902 and 1920. Now home to the Finger Lakes Wine Center.

Naples

ONTARIO COUNTY · SOUTH END OF THE LAKE · POP. ~1,000

BEST FOR GRAPE PIE, FALL COLOR, AND GRIMES GLEN

Naples sits at the bottom of a valley where the hills narrow into some of the most densely planted vineyard terrain in Ontario County, and it takes the Concord grape seriously. The grape pie tradition began in the 1960s when Irene Bouchard was commissioned to make the dessert for Al Hodges' Redwood Restaurant in the village. Naples now calls itself the Grape Pie Capital of the World. The Naples Grape Festival, held on the last full weekend in September, has been running since 1961 and draws more than forty thousand visitors over a single weekend.

Grimes Glen, accessible from a trailhead on Vine Street in the village, is a free waterfall hike along a streambed gorge: roughly one mile round trip, water shoes recommended. The drive south from Canandaigua on Route 21 starts showing fall color by late September most years. The South Bristol Overlook on Route 64 is a newer pull-off with an unobstructed panoramic view of the lake and surrounding hills.

[IMAGE: *Naples village main street or grape pie at the Naples Grape Festival, late September* **]**

Naples, south end of Canandaigua Lake. The Naples Grape Festival has run since 1961 and draws more than 40,000 visitors on the last full weekend of September.

South Bristol

ONTARIO COUNTY · WEST SHORE, MID-LAKE

BEST FOR THE VINEYARD RIDGE ROAD AND WINTER SKI

The western ridge road above the lake passes through South Bristol with views across the water and the Heron Hill tasting room in a 100-year-old barn. Bristol Mountain, a ski area in winter, runs scenic chairlift rides in fall during peak foliage. Ontario County Park at Gannett Hill, the highest point in the county at 2,256 feet, sits on the ridge road between South Bristol and Naples, with views toward multiple Finger Lakes on clear days.

Bloomfield and Victor

ONTARIO COUNTY · NORTHWEST APPROACH

BEST FOR THE GANONDAGAN STATE HISTORIC SITE

The Ganondagan State Historic Site in Victor, about fifteen miles northwest of Canandaigua, is worth treating as part of the lake chapter rather than a detour. It is the most significant Seneca historic site in the country, directly connected to the story of the lake and the Treaty of Canandaigua, and it takes the better part of a morning to do properly.

The Haudenosaunee and the Treaty

[IMAGE: *Ganondagan State Historic Site, Victor NY, Seneca Art and Culture Center or bark longhouse exterior* **]**

Ganondagan State Historic Site, Victor. The only Seneca town developed and interpreted in the United States. National Historic Landmark.

The Seneca are Ondöndowa'ga:', the Great Hill People. Their origin story places the emergence of their people at Nundawao, the Great Hill, at the lake's southern tip near Naples. The name of the lake comes directly from Seneca: tganondæ:gwęh, the Chosen Spot. Fifteen miles northwest of Canandaigua, near Victor, is Ganondagan, the Town of Peace, which was at its 17th-century height one of the largest Seneca towns, home to roughly 4,500 people. Jikonsaseh, the Mother of Nations, whose diplomatic

intervention was essential to founding the Haudenosaunee Confederacy, lived here and is buried nearby. In 1687 the French destroyed it, burning 150 longhouses as part of the fur trade conflicts. The Seneca rebuilt their political life elsewhere, absorbing the further losses of the Sullivan-Clinton Campaign of 1779 under Washington's order.

In November 1794, more than 1,500 Haudenosaunee representatives gathered at Canandaigua for negotiations with the young American republic. The Seneca had invited Quakers from Philadelphia to serve as witnesses, trusting them the way Cayuga communities would trust Quaker abolitionists a generation later in the corridor to the east. On November 11, fifty-nine sachems and war chiefs signed. Red Jacket, Cornplanter, and Handsome Lake among them. The Treaty of Canandaigua affirmed Haudenosaunee sovereignty and land rights, set Seneca territorial boundaries, and established a framework for resolving disputes. The United States still pays the annual cloth annuity promised in Article Six. The treaty has never been broken. Every November 11, the Haudenosaunee return to the Ontario County Courthouse to commemorate it, in a ceremony they call brightening the chain of friendship. The original parchment is held by the Ontario County Historical Society and is made available for public viewing that day.

Ganondagan today is a National Historic Landmark and the only New York State Historic Site dedicated to a Native American theme. The Seneca Art and Culture Center, opened in 2015, runs 17,300 square feet of multimedia exhibits including an orientation theater where the Iroquois Creation Story is told by Seneca people themselves. Three trail systems cross 569 acres; a full-scale bark longhouse stands on the Trail of Peace. Visiting Ganondagan before the treaty ground in Canandaigua makes both stops more legible.

[IMAGE: *Treaty of Canandaigua Commemoration, November 11, Ontario County Courthouse, Canandaigua NY* **]**

Treaty of Canandaigua Commemoration, November 11, Ontario County Courthouse. The Haudenosaunee return annually. The ceremony is open to the public.

Heritage sites, full list

BADGE TRACK: ALL SITES BELOW ARE TAGGED TO THE FINGER LAKES HERITAGE TRAIL PASSPORT BADGE.

- Ganondagan State Historic Site, Victor NY: National Historic Landmark. Seneca Art and Culture Center (2015), 17th-century bark longhouse reconstruction, three interpretive trails across 569 acres. The only Seneca town developed and interpreted in the United States. Open Wednesday through Saturday.
- Ontario County Historical Society, Canandaigua NY: Holds the original Treaty of Canandaigua parchment. Made available for public viewing during Treaty Day (November 11) commemorations.
- Ontario County Courthouse, Canandaigua NY: Site of the 1794 Treaty of Canandaigua negotiations and Susan B. Anthony's 1873 suffrage trial. Active courthouse; Treaty Day ceremony on the front lawn.
- Sonnenberg Gardens and Mansion State Historic Park, Canandaigua NY: Victorian estate, 1887 Queen Anne mansion, nine formal gardens, Finger Lakes Wine Center. Path Through History site. Open May through October.
- Granger Homestead and Carriage Museum, Canandaigua NY: 1816 Federal-style mansion of Gideon Granger, first U.S. Postmaster General. Carriage museum, period furnishings, guided tours.

The Canandaigua Lake Wine Trail

[IMAGE: *Heron Hill tasting room barn on Canandaigua Lake, South Bristol, lake views visible, fall or summer* **]**

Heron Hill Tasting Room on Canandaigua Lake, South Bristol. A 100-year-old barn on the western ridge above the lake.

The Canandaigua Lake Wine Trail is the smallest of the major Finger Lakes loops: six producers running from Victor south through Canandaigua and along the lake's western ridge to Naples, 30 miles from end to end. The south-end cluster around Naples makes it the most food-integrated wine loop in the region: wineries, grape pie, Grimes Glen, and a valley drive all within thirty minutes of each other.

What distinguishes the Canandaigua expression: lighter body, more fruit-forward, and a tasting culture that tends toward approachability. The south end, where the valley compresses and the Concord-planted hills are dense, produces wines that prioritize the agricultural character of the place. For visitors new to the region, this is often the right lake to start with.

Producers worth naming

Arbor Hill Grapery and Winery, South Bristol: The south-end anchor. The Brahm family opened in 1987 in a complex of vintage buildings on Route 64, just north of Naples, on a grape-growing tradition that goes back four generations. Arbor Hill was the first operation in the region to produce Traminette, a spicy Gewurztraminer hybrid that has since become a signature variety for the Finger Lakes. The Naples grape pie is available year-round at the retail shop.

Hazlitt Red Cat Cellars, Naples: Housed in the former Widmer Wine Cellars facility, one of the historic Naples wine operations. Red Cat, a semi-sweet red blend, is among the best-selling wines in New York State. The Hazlitt family has farmed Finger Lakes vineyards since 1852.

Heron Hill Tasting Room on Canandaigua Lake, South Bristol: A satellite location of Heron Hill Winery, in a 100-year-old barn on the western ridge with views of the lake. Live music and wood-fired pizza on Saturdays in season.

Inspire Moore Winery, Naples: Small-production estate wines from the surrounding hills, in the heart of the village.

Hometown Wine Company, Naples: A newer addition in the village. Small production, approachable.

Casa Larga Vineyards, Fairport: The northernmost stop on the trail, outside Victor, with a vineyard campus and structured tasting experience.

How to run the trail

Start at Sonnenberg Gardens in Canandaigua for the Finger Lakes Wine Center overview, then drive south on Route 21, stopping at Heron Hill on the western ridge in South Bristol. Continue south to Naples for Arbor Hill, Hazlitt, Inspire Moore, and Hometown Wine Company. Return north on Route 64 past the South Bristol Overlook. One day, no backtracking, and enough time for Grimes Glen or, in late September, the Naples Grape Festival. Tasting rooms run full hours May through November; call ahead December through April.

Farms, outdoor, and nature

- Grimes Glen, Naples: Free waterfall hike from a trailhead on Vine Street. Stream walk through a gorge, roughly one mile round trip, water shoes recommended. Open year-round.
- Bristol Mountain, South Bristol: Ski resort December through March. Scenic chairlift rides in fall during peak foliage with panoramic views of the lake valley.
- Ontario County Park at Gannett Hill, South Bristol: Highest point in Ontario County at 2,256 feet. Hiking trails with views toward multiple Finger Lakes on clear days. Primitive camping.
- Cumming Nature Center, Naples: 900-acre environmental education center with 9 miles of trails through forest and wetland. Cross-country skiing in winter.

- South Bristol Overlook, Route 21 south of Canandaigua: Pull-off with an unobstructed view of the lake and vineyard hills. Worth the stop on the drive south.
- Canandaigua Lady: Public cruises on the lake from the city pier, May through October. Sightseeing, dinner cruises, and private events.

Where to eat

Canandaigua

- 22 North Restaurant, Canandaigua: Locally sourced, seasonal menu. The primary independent dinner option downtown.
- Twisted Rail Brewing Company, Canandaigua: Craft brewery downtown. Food, outdoor space, local beer.
- New York Kitchen, Canandaigua: Culinary education and tasting center on Routes 5 and 20. Rotating classes and a tasting bar covering Finger Lakes food and wine.
- Nolan's on Canandaigua Lake, Canandaigua: Lakefront. Seafood chowder, burgers, lake views.
- Lake House Rose Tavern, Canandaigua: Inside the Lake House resort, locally sourced dinner, lakefront setting.

Naples and South Bristol

- Monica's Pies, Naples: The village source for grape pie. Also available at Arbor Hill year-round.
- The Brown Hound Downtown, Naples: Farm-to-table bistro in the village. Seasonal sourcing, the dinner option at the south end.
- Arbor Hill Brew and Brats, South Bristol: Historic carriage barn in the Arbor Hill complex. Bristol Springs craft beer, locally made brats, house wines. The lunch stop on the south-end wine trail day.

Where to stay

Lake House, Canandaigua: A 124-room lakefront resort opened in 2020, walking distance from downtown and the courthouse. Rose Tavern serves dinner; the Sand Bar is dockside in season.

Sutherland House Bed and Breakfast, Canandaigua: Victorian B&B walking distance from Sonnenberg Gardens and the Ontario County Courthouse. Five rooms, full breakfast.

Bristol Harbour Resort, South Bristol: On the western ridge above the lake, with a marina, restaurant, and cottages overlooking the water. Golf course on site.

Monier Manor, Canandaigua: Historic B&B close to the waterfront. The quieter option for the north-end base.

Getting here and getting around

Canandaigua Lake requires a car. Greater Rochester International Airport is 40 minutes north, the closest commercial airport with significant routes. Syracuse Hancock International Airport is 90 minutes east. From New York City: five and a half hours, I-87 north to I-90 west to Route 332 south.

Drive times on the lake

Canandaigua to Naples	Route 21 south	30 minutes
Canandaigua to South Bristol	Route 64	20 minutes
Canandaigua to Ganondagan (Victor)	Route 332 / 444	20 minutes
Canandaigua to Seneca Falls	Route 20 east	25 minutes
Canandaigua to Geneva	Route 5 and 20 west	30 minutes
Canandaigua to Rochester Airport	I-490 west	40 minutes

The shore roads

Route 21 runs the western valley from Canandaigua south through the vineyard corridor to Naples: the primary wine trail drive, the fall foliage route, the grape pie run. The wine trail loop is a south-and-return on the west: Canandaigua to Naples via Route 21, Naples back north via Route 64, which climbs the western ridge for the South Bristol Overlook and the Heron Hill barn. Route 5 and 20 connects the north end to Seneca Falls (25 minutes east) and to Geneva (30 minutes west).

Seasonal notes

Wine trail tasting rooms: full hours May through November, reduced or appointment-only December through April, call ahead. Naples Grape Festival: last full weekend of September. Grimes Glen: open year-round. Bristol Mountain ski season: December through March; fall chairlift rides, check schedule. Canandaigua Lady: May through October. Sonnenberg Gardens: May through October. Treaty Day: November 11 at the Ontario County Courthouse, open to the public.

WINE TRAIL STAMPS	HERITAGE STAMPS	OUTDOOR STAMPS
6 producers tagged to the Canandaigua Lake Wine Trail badge. Count toward the Finger Lakes Wine master badge.	Ganondagan, Ontario County Courthouse, Historical Society, Granger Homestead, Sonnenberg Gardens — all Finger Lakes Heritage Trail badge.	Grimes Glen, Gannett Hill, Cumming Nature Center — Finger Lakes Outdoor badge.

The Eastern Lakes

[Chapter in progress — Skaneateles, Owasco, the quieter ones — the Finger Lakes before the brand arrived]

The Eastern Lakes

Six lakes that never decided to become a brand. That is the reason to visit.

Chapter draft · Onondaga, Cayuga, Ontario, Livingston, and Cortland counties · March 2026

[IMAGE: *Skaneateles Lake from the village, looking south, fall color on surrounding hills, morning light preferred* **]**

Skaneateles Lake, looking south from the village. 16 miles long, 315 feet deep, the second cleanest lake in the United States by dissolved nitrogen. The city of Syracuse draws its drinking water here, unfiltered.

The lakes, and what they keep refusing to become

The eastern Finger Lakes are the ones the wine trail identity never fully claimed. Skaneateles is the clearest lake in the region and one of the cleanest in the country, and it has never built an identity around that fact. Owasco gave Harriet Tubman a home and Millard Fillmore a birthplace and largely lets both coexist in the same county without straining either. Hemlock and Canadice chose to become Rochester's water supply in 1876 and ended up as old-growth wilderness, the only two undeveloped Finger Lakes, home to the last bald eagle pair in New York State when the recovery effort started in 1965. Honeoye is the warmest lake and the most frankly recreational, a cottage culture built by working people in the 1930s who wanted a lake and didn't need it to mean anything else. Otisco is the easternmost, closest to Syracuse, and the least visited, which is its own argument.

The thing these lakes share is restraint. None of them has been packaged. The village at the north end of Skaneateles Lake has been drawing visitors for two centuries on the strength of the lake itself, a well-preserved 19th-century main street, and the knowledge that the water in the lake is clean enough to drink unfiltered. William Henry Seward called it "the most beautiful body of water in the world." He was Secretary of State, so he'd seen a few.

> *The water in Skaneateles Lake is clean enough that the city of Syracuse draws it unfiltered for 165,000 people. It is the second cleanest lake in the United States by dissolved nitrogen, after Crater Lake in Oregon. The village at its north end has been doing exactly what it has always done, and no one has felt the need to rename it or brand it, and that's the whole story.*

The Onondaga Nation, whose territory this was, had a village on Skaneateles Lake's southwest shore when the first European settlers arrived in 1793 following an Indian trail that would become the Seneca Turnpike. The Sullivan-Clinton Campaign of 1779 had moved through this corridor fourteen years before that first settler. The lakes still carry their Haudenosaunee names: Skaneateles means long lake in the Onondaga language; Owasco, Otisco, Canadice, and Honeoye all derive from languages of the Confederacy. The land kept the names. The people who gave them are still here.

LAKE	LENGTH	DEPTH	COUNTY	CHARACTER

Skaneateles	16 miles	315 feet	Onondaga / Cayuga / Cortland	Unfiltered Syracuse water supply. No wine trail. The clearest lake in the Finger Lakes.
Owasco	11 miles	177 feet	Cayuga	Auburn at the north. Harriet Tubman, Seward House, Willard Chapel. Fillmore Glen at the south.
Hemlock	7 miles	176 feet	Livingston	Rochester drinking water since 1876. Undeveloped shoreline. Old-growth forest. Bald eagle recovery.
Canadice	3 miles	90 feet	Ontario / Livingston	Smallest Finger Lake. Highest elevation (1,100 ft). Flows to Rochester by gravity. No development.
Honeoye	4.5 miles	30 feet	Ontario	Warmest lake in summer. Cottage culture since the 1930s. Ring of Fire tradition.
Otisco	5.5 miles	66 feet	Onondaga	Easternmost Finger Lake. Closest to Syracuse. Tiger muskie and walleye fishing.

Skaneateles Lake

[IMAGE: *Skaneateles village main street (Genesee Street) looking toward the lake, summer or fall* **]**

Skaneateles village. The main street runs to Clift Park at the water's edge. Population 2,533. The Sherwood Inn has been on this corner since 1807.

The village of Skaneateles sits at the lake's north end where Genesee Street runs straight to the water and stops. The Sherwood Inn, built in 1807 as a stagecoach stop, is still the center of gravity: 25 rooms, a tavern that has been open in some form for over two centuries, views of the lake from the dining room. The village is small enough to walk in twenty minutes and dense enough in 19th-century architecture that those twenty minutes pass slowly in the best way.

The water quality is the foundational fact. Skaneateles Lake is the second cleanest lake in the United States by dissolved nitrogen, after Crater Lake in Oregon. The City of Syracuse has drawn its drinking water from the lake unfiltered since 1894, when it ran a 19-mile pipeline at a cost of $4 million. Today the lake supplies more than 165,000 people, one of only six unfiltered municipal water supplies in the country. Syracuse spends $2.3 million annually protecting the watershed: sixteen inspectors make two annual visits to each of the 2,600 properties in the watershed. The filtration avoidance waiver, granted in 2004, has no expiration date as long as water quality standards hold.

The Underground Railroad ran through Skaneateles with more organization than most visitors realize. An 1876 local historian wrote that the town had "eclipsed Syracuse as an anti-slavery town." Quaker families were central to both the community and the movement. James Canning Fuller's house at 98 Genesee Street, built 1815, was a documented station. The Skaneateles Historical Society at the Creamery on Hannum Street holds the documented record.

What to do in the village

Mid-Lakes Navigation runs sightseeing cruises, dinner cruises, and one of the last working mail boat services in the United States: the US Mail Boat delivers to lakeside homes along the eastern shore while passengers ride along. It is the most unusual 2.5-hour tour available on any Finger Lake. Skaneateles also has one of the region's better chamber music programs: the Skaneateles Festival runs through August with world-class performers drawing around 7,000 visitors across the month. The Dickens Christmas celebration, running every weekend from Thanksgiving through Christmas since 1994, brings 5,000 visitors per weekend to a village of 2,533. Charles Dickens characters work the streets. Horse-drawn wagons circle the block. It draws people back annually in a way that wine trails rarely do.

The Bahar Nature Preserve, 53 acres just outside the village, holds 65 feet of lake shoreline and the trail to Carpenter Falls, a 90-foot waterfall dropping into a deep pool via Bear Swamp Creek gorge. It is free, open year-round, and almost always less crowded than the gorge trails further south. The Charlie Major Nature Trail runs a flat 4.4 miles from the village south to Mottville along the old Short Line railroad bed. Beak & Skiff Apple Orchard, a 114-year-old operation on Route 20 three miles east of the village, added a cidery, distillery, tasting room, and summer concert series without abandoning the orchard identity that built it.

Where to eat and drink

- Rosalie's Cucina, Skaneateles: Tuscan-style dining, 30-plus years, national recognition in the New York Times and Food Network. Reservations required. The dinner reservation in the village.
- Doug's Fish Fry, Skaneateles: Since 1982. Fresh seafood delivered on ice daily. Fish, chowder, fries, coleslaw. If you pick one place in the village, this is the one.
- Sherwood Inn Tavern, Skaneateles: The 1807 building, the bar with lake views, the place that has been open longer than the state has been in its current form.
- Bluewater Grill, Skaneateles: Casual lakefront dining. Lobster bisque, fried calamari, grilled salmon. The outdoor-table option in summer.
- Gilda's, Skaneateles: Craft pizza and local beer sourced well. Good for the lunch stop on a day around the lake.
- Skaneateles Brewery / Last Shot Distillery, Skaneateles: The first barreled whiskey in Onondaga County since Prohibition, in a building that housed a distillery in the 1800s. Last Shot won the Moonshiners competition on Season 3 of Master Distiller. The brewery is in the same building.

Where to stay

- Sherwood Inn, Skaneateles: 25 rooms in the 1807 building. Some with lake views, fireplaces, four-poster beds. The center of the village and the center of Dickens Christmas.
- Mirbeau Inn & Spa, Skaneateles: Forbes Travel Guide Four-Star. French chateau-inspired, lily ponds, Monet-inspired gardens, mineral baths. 34 rooms plus four cottages. The spa-forward option.
- Hannum House, Skaneateles: Stately 19th-century B&B, five rooms, the quieter independent option within the village.

Owasco Lake

[IMAGE: *Owasco Lake looking north toward Auburn, or Harriet Tubman National Historical Park, Auburn NY* **]**

Owasco Lake, Cayuga County. Auburn anchors the north with the Harriet Tubman National Historical Park, the Seward House, and the only complete unaltered Tiffany interior in the United States.

Owasco Lake is 11 miles long, anchored at its north by Auburn and at its south by Moravia and Fillmore Glen State Park. The lake itself has public beach access at Emerson Park and Owasco Flats, and draws

regional visitors for boating and fishing. But the reason to come here is the six blocks in downtown Auburn and the gorge a half-hour south.

Auburn is covered in full in the Cayuga Lake chapter, but its claim belongs to Owasco as much as anywhere: within six blocks of downtown, you have the Harriet Tubman National Historical Park, the Seward House Museum, the Willard Memorial Chapel (the only complete, unaltered Louis Comfort Tiffany interior in the United States, 1894), and the NYS Equal Rights Heritage Center. Tubman moved to Auburn in 1859 and stayed 54 years. Seward arranged the land sale, held the mortgage privately, was flexible about payments. Frederick Douglass was a frequent visitor to the Seward House.

The Auburn Correctional Facility, established 1816, is the second-oldest state prison in New York and the site of the first execution by electric chair in history, carried out on August 6, 1890. The prisoner was William Kemler; the first shock did not kill him. Auburn Prison developed the Auburn System of prison labor, widely imitated across the country. The Cayuga Museum of History and Art and the Case Research Lab preserve another Auburn invention: Theodore Case developed the first successful sound-on-film technology in Auburn in the 1920s, making the talking picture possible. The Case Research Lab building still stands.

Fillmore Glen State Park — the south end

Fillmore Glen State Park sits on 941 acres just south of Moravia, one mile from the village that produced the 13th President of the United States. Millard Fillmore was born January 7, 1800, in a log cabin five miles from what is now the park. He married his one-room schoolhouse teacher in Moravia. He became president in 1850 upon Zachary Taylor's death and signed the Fugitive Slave Act, which made him deeply unpopular with his own Auburn neighbors, including Seward and the Tubman network two counties east. The cabin was demolished in 1852 while Fillmore was sitting president; the replica now in the park was constructed in 1965. The park was acquired by the state in 1925 and named for Fillmore. The trails and stonework were built by the Civilian Conservation Corps between 1934 and 1938.

The gorge at Fillmore Glen holds five waterfalls including Cowshed Falls, where the creek drops 30 feet under a natural overhang large enough that cattle historically sheltered inside it during storms. The CCC stone staircase and bridges are as well-built as anything in the Finger Lakes gorge parks. The stream-fed swimming pool and 60 campsites make it a full-day destination rather than a drive-by stop. It is far less visited than the gorge parks near Ithaca and Watkins Glen, which is the reason to go.

Owasco Lake sites, full list

BADGE TRACK: HERITAGE SITES TAGGED TO THE FINGER LAKES HERITAGE TRAIL PASSPORT BADGE.

- Harriet Tubman National Historical Park, Auburn NY: The residence at 180 South Street, the Home for the Aged, and the Thompson AME Zion Church. NPS visitor center at the church. Tubman lived here from 1859 until her death in 1913.
- Seward House Museum, Auburn NY: Documented Underground Railroad stop. Original furnishings. Seward negotiated the purchase of Alaska from Russia in 1867. National Historic Landmark.
- Willard Memorial Chapel, Auburn NY: The only complete, unaltered Louis Comfort Tiffany interior in the United States. Glass, tiles, metalwork, furnishings, all 1894. Most people driving through Auburn don't know it exists.
- NYS Equal Rights Heritage Center, Auburn NY: Exhibits on Tubman, Stanton, the reform network, and Auburn's place in civil rights history. Path Through History site.
- Fort Hill Cemetery, Auburn NY: Tubman's burial site. The marker is famously spare.
- Cayuga Museum of History and Art and Case Research Lab, Auburn NY: Home of Theodore Case's sound-on-film archives and the lab where the talking picture was made possible.

— Fillmore Glen State Park, Moravia NY: 941 acres, five waterfalls, CCC stonework, 60 campsites, stream-fed swimming pool. Millard Fillmore birthplace replica. Open mid-April through mid-November for trails and camping.

— Emerson Park, Auburn NY: Public beach on Owasco Lake, seasonal amusement area, Merry-Go-Round Playhouse professional theater. The north-end public lakefront access.

Hemlock and Canadice Lakes

[IMAGE: *Hemlock Lake looking south, undeveloped forested shoreline, canoe or kayak in foreground, summer or fall* **]**

Hemlock Lake, Livingston County. The shoreline has been undeveloped since 1947, when the City of Rochester acquired and demolished the last cottages. 415 acres of old-growth forest on the southwest shore contain trees up to 500 years old.

In the 1880s, Hemlock Lake was a resort destination: 80 cottages, several hotels, a railroad from Rochester, a steam-driven tour boat cruising its seven-mile length. A cholera epidemic had ravaged Rochester in the mid-1800s, the city unable to eradicate the disease from its cisterns and wells. In 1872, it identified Hemlock and Canadice as the solution. A January 1876 newspaper headline announced: "Glory! Hemlock Water at Last!" By 1895 Rochester was acquiring shoreline properties. By 1947 the last cottage was gone. By 1951 the final structure on Canadice was stripped. In 2010, New York State purchased ~7,000 acres from the city and established Hemlock-Canadice State Forest. The resort lake became the wildest Finger Lake by institutional decision, and has stayed that way.

The 415-acre old-growth tract on Hemlock's southwest shore contains trees up to 500 years old, among the largest old-growth stands in the northeastern United States. In 1965, amateur naturalist and utility lineman Tom Rauber discovered the last known nesting pair of bald eagles in New York State on a forested ridge above the south end of Hemlock Lake. He spent the next 27 years, initially in secret, documenting the birds. His observations, combined with a state wildlife program that began in the mid-1970s, anchored one of American conservation's most consequential recovery efforts. Bald eagles continue to nest in the Hemlock-Canadice watershed alongside sharp-shinned hawks, northern harriers, red-headed woodpeckers, and cerulean warblers. The Hemlock-Canadice watershed is a designated Important Bird Area by the National Audubon Society.

Canadice is the smallest Finger Lake, three miles long, and the highest in elevation at 1,100 feet. Its elevation means its water flows to Rochester entirely by gravity, no pumps required. Together Hemlock and Canadice deliver 37 million gallons of drinking water to Rochester and surrounding communities daily. They are the only two undeveloped Finger Lakes.

Access and what to do

Boats are limited to 17 feet and 10 horsepower on both lakes; swimming is prohibited. The Hemlock-Canadice State Forest is open to hiking, fishing, hunting, and paddling within those constraints. Rob's Trail, completed in 2016 and named for conservationist Rob van der Stricht, connects the east shore of Hemlock to the west shore of Canadice through gorges and forest with a waterfall en route: the most satisfying cross-lake walk in the Finger Lakes, and almost no one knows it. A 4-mile trail parallels Canadice's west shore for its full length from north to south. The Hemlock Lake Park at the north end of Hemlock has a small picnic area and boat launch. There are no facilities on Canadice whatsoever. Come prepared.

> *The resort lake became the wildest Finger Lake by institutional decision. Rochester needed clean water. The cottages came down. The forest came back. The bald eagles chose Hemlock first, and then the rest of New York followed.*

Honeoye Lake

[IMAGE: *Honeoye Lake summer, cottage shoreline, small boats, warm afternoon light* **]**

Honeoye Lake, Ontario County. The warmest Finger Lake in summer. 235 lakefront cottages, many built in the 1930s for middle-class workers who wanted a lake without pretense.

Honeoye Lake is the warmest of the Finger Lakes in summer and the shallowest at 30 feet, which is the source of both its recreational appeal and its eutrophication challenges. At 4.5 miles long, it is the second smallest of the Finger Lakes after Canadice. Its name comes from the Seneca ha-ne-a-yah, meaning "lying finger."

The character of Honeoye was set by who built there. The 235 lakefront cottages were designed modestly, a resort area for middle-class workers who wanted affordable lakefront property. Many were built during the Great Depression in the 1930s. Residents have gradually extended and renovated them over the decades, and a growing number now stay year-round. Honeoye has sometimes been called the working man's lake, which is meant as a description, not a diminishment: it has been honestly itself from the start, without the strain of an identity it wasn't built to support.

The Honeoye Ring of Fire tradition runs on summer evenings, a ring of lit torches placed along the shoreline by residents: a synchronized community event that has no formal organization and no admission charge and has been happening long enough that no one is entirely sure when it started. It is the kind of thing that doesn't photograph well and is better for it. The village of Honeoye Falls, a few miles north of the lake, has a small-town main street that rewards a stop on the drive in.

Otisco Lake

[IMAGE: *Otisco Lake, Onondaga County, wooded shoreline, causeway visible, late summer or fall* **]**

Otisco Lake. The easternmost Finger Lake, closest to Syracuse. Bisected by a rock causeway; the northern basin is deep and clear, the southern shallow and weedy. 11,000 tiger muskies stocked annually.

Otisco Lake is the easternmost of the eleven, 5.5 miles long, 66 feet at its deepest, sitting in Onondaga County southwest of Syracuse. Its proximity to the city makes it overlooked by visitors coming from outside the region, which is not the same thing as undervalued. A rock causeway bisects the south end: the northern basin is deep and clear; the southern shallow, turbid, and weedy, which makes it excellent habitat for bass and panfish alongside the stocked species.

The New York State DEC stocks 11,000 tiger muskies in Otisco annually and more than 40,000 walleye on a biannual schedule, making it the most seriously managed fishery among the eastern lakes. The annual bass tournament draws thousands. Otisco also serves as a municipal water supply for parts of the county. The surrounding land is forested and largely undeveloped, with a quieter character than its proximity to Syracuse might suggest. For the angler who doesn't need the region to have a wine trail, this is the right lake.

Getting here and getting around

The eastern lakes require a car. Syracuse Hancock International Airport is 30 minutes from Skaneateles and 45 minutes from Auburn. Greater Rochester International Airport is 45 minutes from Hemlock Lake and about an hour from Skaneateles. From New York City: four hours to Skaneateles, I-87 north to I-90 west to Route 321 south.

Drive times

Skaneateles to Auburn	US Route 20 west	20 minutes
Skaneateles to Syracuse	Route 321 north to I-690	30 minutes
Auburn to Moravia (Fillmore Glen)	Route 38 south	25 minutes
Hemlock Lake to Canadice Lake	Bald Hill Rd / Rob's Trail	10 minutes
Hemlock to Honeoye Lake	Route 20A east	20 minutes
Skaneateles to Otisco Lake	Route 41A north	15 minutes
Skaneateles to Ithaca	Route 41 south	45 minutes

How these lakes connect

US Route 20 is the organizing road for the eastern Finger Lakes, running east-west through Auburn and Skaneateles and connecting to the wine trail towns to the west. From Skaneateles, Route 41 runs the lake's west shore south toward Ithaca. Route 41A runs the east shore. Hemlock and Canadice are reached via Route 15A from the north (from Avon or Livonia) or via back roads from Honeoye to the east. Honeoye sits on Route 20A; Otisco is reached via Route 174 from Syracuse or via Amber south of Marcellus. The eastern lakes are not a circuit in the way that Seneca's two shore roads are: they require a navigator and some intention. That is also the point.

Seasonal notes

Skaneateles year-round: Dickens Christmas every weekend Thanksgiving through Christmas; Mid-Lakes Navigation cruises May through October; Skaneateles Festival August; Beak & Skiff harvest season September and October. Fillmore Glen: gorge trails mid-May through mid-November; Fillmore cabin mid-April through mid-November; camping May through October. Hemlock-Canadice State Forest: open year-round, no seasonal facilities. Honeoye: peak season June through August; Ring of Fire check local schedule. Otisco: bass tournament late summer, check NYS DEC schedule.

HERITAGE STAMPS	OUTDOOR STAMPS	CRAFT BEVERAGE STAMPS
Tubman NHP, Seward House, Willard Chapel, Equal Rights Heritage Center, Fort Hill Cemetery, Case Research Lab, Fillmore Glen — all Finger Lakes Heritage Trail badge.	Bahar Preserve, Carpenter Falls, Charlie Major Trail, Hemlock-Canadice State Forest, Rob's Trail, Fillmore Glen — Finger Lakes Outdoor badge.	Beak & Skiff, Skaneateles Brewery, Last Shot Distillery, Anyela's Vineyards — Finger Lakes Craft Beverage Trail badge.

PART 3